ACPC Notes — Contents

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1. Contest Playbook

1.1 ACPC, Kattis, and Team Strategy

How to use these notes. Stuck on a problem → go to *When You're Stuck* (§1.3): constraint → complexity table, then keyword → technique table, which points to the section with code. Every C++ block compiles as-is after the template (§1.2) with `#include <bits/stdc++.h>`, `using namespace std;`, `using ll = long long;`. Blocks marked **[stress-tested]** were checked against brute force; the rest compile and were hand-verified, so still test on samples.

1.1.1 What ACPC looks like (from all sets 2016–2024 on Kattis)

- 8–15 problems per set. Kattis difficulty (1–10 scale) spread is very consistent:
- **~35% easy (1.2–2.9):** implementation, careful reading, simulation. Solve these *fast and without WA* — penalty time decides ranks among teams with equal solves.
- **~35% medium (3.0–5.0):** one standard idea: binary search on answer + greedy, monotonic stack, Dijkstra/BFS with a twist, tree DP, counting mod p, interval DP, grid flood fill, offline DSU.
- **~30% hard (5.1–8.3):** probability/expected-value DP, flows with modelling (min flow with lower bounds, assignment), FFT, number theory (factoring, gcd tricks), interactive problems with tiny query budgets, geometry + search, string canonical forms, nasty interval DP.
- Expert/CM level: easy+medium ≈ CF Div2 A–C; hard ≈ Div2 D–F / Div1 C–D. Hard ACPC problems are usually *one known technique plus modelling* rather than research-level tricks — recognizing the model is the whole game. See §1.4 for every past problem mapped to its technique.
- Themes recur: Kattis "Medium/Hard" problems from ACPC very often involve **probability**, **flows/matching**, **Dijkstra on augmented state**, **binary search on the answer**, and **number theory**.

1.1.2 Kattis specifics

- Language: C++ compiled with GCC, `-O2`, gnu++17 or newer, 64-bit. `__int128`, `__builtin_*`, `<bits/stdc++.h>`, `__gnu_pbds` all work.
- Time limit is **per test file**; there may be dozens of files. Memory is usually 1024 MB (check the problem page).
- Verdicts stop at the first failing test file — you don't learn which case failed. A WA on test 1 means the sample itself fails (or format is wrong).
- Output: trailing whitespace/newline differences are ignored. Floating answers are accepted within the stated absolute/relative error; print with `fixed << setprecision(10)`.
- **Interactive problems** (ACPC 2024 had two): flush after every query (`cout << ... << endl` or `cout.flush()`), never read past what the judge sends, terminate immediately after the final answer. See §10.1.
- Multiple test cases inside one file (`T` given): **reset all global state**.
- Python: big integers are trivial in Python; consider it for one-off big-number problems (e.g. ACPC 2017 *Divide by 100* has numbers with 10^6 digits — just string manipulation though).
- Recursion: Kattis has a generous stack, but DFS depth 10^6 in C++ is still risky; prefer iterative for path graphs with $n \geq 10^6$.

1.1.3 Team strategy (2–3 people, one machine)

1. **First 15 min:** split the problem set; everyone reads, labels each problem `easy / medium / hard / unknown` and writes one-line summary + constraints on paper. Read *all* problems — ACPC difficulty is not ordered by letter.
2. **Keyboard discipline:** only one person types; others think on paper. Never debug at the keyboard while someone with a ready solution waits — print/write the code and debug on paper.
3. Watch the scoreboard: problems solved by many teams are easier than they look. If 10 teams solved X and you think it's hard, you're missing something simple.
4. **Before submitting:** run all samples, a tiny edge case ($n = 1$, all equal, max values), and check output format. One WA costs 20 minutes of penalty.
5. **After WA:** reread the statement *first* (most WAs are misreads), then check §1.3 bug list, then write a brute force and compare on random small inputs.
6. **Last hour:** stop starting new hard problems unless the idea is complete; finish/debug what's closest. Freeze-time submissions still count.
7. Two people can pair on the hardest problem: one explains the problem from scratch to the other — this exposes wrong assumptions.

1.1.4 Precision and number sizes (memorize)

type	max	notes
`int`	$2.1 \cdot 10^9$	`a*b` overflows when both $\sim 5 \cdot 10^4$
`long long`	$9.2 \cdot 10^{18}$	product of two 10^9 values fits; two 10^{10} doesn't
`__int128`	$1.7 \cdot 10^{38}$	multiply two `ll` safely; no I/O, write a printer
`double`	15–16 digits	integers exact up to $2^{53} \approx 9 \cdot 10^{15}$
`long double`	18–19 digits	80-bit on x86 GCC; slower but helps precision

- Operations/second: $\sim 3 \cdot 10^8$ simple ops in 1 s with `-O2`; `set/map` $\sim 10^7$ ops/s; `unordered_map` $\sim 3 \cdot 10^7$ with reserve; `cin` with sync off $\sim 10^7$ ints/s.
- Memory: `int` array of 10^8 = 400 MB. `vector<vector<int>>` with 10^6 small vectors has big overhead — use CSR / flat arrays.

1.2 Template, Debugging, Stress Testing

1.2.1 Main template

```cpp
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std;
using ll = long long;
using ull = unsigned long long;
using ld = long double;
using pii = pair<int, int>;
using pll = pair<ll, ll>;
#define all(x) begin(x), end(x)
#define sz(x) (int)(x).size()
#define rep(i, a, b) for (int i = (a); i < (b); ++i)
#ifdef LOCAL
#define dbg(...) cerr << "[" << #__VA_ARGS__ << "] = ", _dbg(__VA_ARGS__)
template <class T> void _dbg(const T& x) { cerr << x << endl; }
template <class T, class... R> void _dbg(const T& x, const R&... r) {
    cerr << x << ", "; _dbg(r...);
}
#else
#define dbg(...)
#endif
const ll INF = 4e18;  // careful: INF + INF overflows. Use 1e18 if you add two.
const int MOD = 1e9 + 7;

void solve() {
}

int main() {
    cin.tie(nullptr)->sync_with_stdio(false);
    int T = 1;
    // cin >> T;
    while (T--) solve();
}
```

Compile locally: `g++ -std=gnu++17 -O2 -Wall -Wextra -DLOCAL -fsanitize=address,undefined -g a.cpp`. Sanitizers catch out-of-bounds and signed overflow immediately — use them whenever you get RE/WA.

1.2.2 Useful snippets

```cpp
// print __int128
void print128(__int128 x) {
    if (x < 0) { putchar('-'); x = -x; }
    if (x > 9) print128(x / 10);
    putchar('0' + (int)(x % 10));
}
// floor/ceil division that work for negatives
ll fdiv(ll a, ll b) { return a / b - ((a % b != 0) && ((a < 0) != (b < 0))); }
ll cdiv(ll a, ll b) { return a / b + ((a % b != 0) && ((a < 0) == (b < 0))); }
// exact integer sqrt (floor)
ll isqrt(ll n) { ll r = sqrtl((ld)n); while (r * r > n) --r; while ((r + 1) * (r + 1) <= n) ++r; return r; }
// random
mt19937_64 rng(chrono::steady_clock::now().time_since_epoch().count());
ll rnd(ll l, ll r) { return uniform_int_distribution<ll>(l, r)(rng); }
// anti-hack hash for unordered_map<ll, V, chash>
```

```cpp
struct chash {
    static ull sm(ull x) { x += 0x9e3779b97f4a7c15; x = (x ^ (x >> 30)) * 0xbf58476d1ce4e5b9;
        x = (x ^ (x >> 27)) * 0x94d049bb133111eb; return x ^ (x >> 31); }
    size_t operator()(ull x) const { static const ull R = rng(); return sm(x + R); }
};
// hash a pair: use key = (ll)a << 32 | (unsigned)b
```

- Read until EOF: `while (cin >> x)`. Read a line: `getline(cin, s)`; after `cin >> n` call `cin.ignore()` (or `getline` once) before the first `getline`.
- Output many lines: use `'\n'`, never `endl` (except interactive).
- Doubles: `cout << fixed << setprecision(10) << x;` — avoid printing `-0.000000` (add `+ 0.0` or check `abs(x) < eps`).
- Sorting with comparator must be a *strict weak ordering* (`<`, never `<=`), otherwise RE/UB.
- `lower_bound(all(v), x)` → first `>= x`; `upper_bound` → first `> x`. Count of `x` in sorted v: `upper - lower`.
- `set.lower_bound(x)` is O(log n); `lower_bound(all(set), x)` is **O(n)**. Same for multiset/map.
- `multiset.erase(x)` removes **all** copies of x; use `ms.erase(ms.find(x))`.
- `priority_queue` is a max-heap; min-heap: `priority_queue<T, vector<T>, greater<T>>`.
- `accumulate(all(v), 0LL)` — the `0LL` matters.
- `(int)v.size() - 1` — `v.size() - 1` is unsigned and wraps when empty.
- `1 << k` is `int`; use `1LL << k` for k ≥ 31. `__builtin_popcountll` for `ll`.
- `memset` only for 0 / -1 / `0x3f` (int ≈ 1.06e9, sum of two still fits) .

1.2.3 Stress testing (do this after the first unexplained WA)

```bash
# gen.py prints a random small test; brute.cpp is the obviously-correct slow solution
g++ -O2 -o sol sol.cpp && g++ -O2 -o brute brute.cpp
for i in $(seq 1 1000); do
  python3 gen.py $i > in.txt
  ./sol < in.txt > o1.txt; ./brute < in.txt > o2.txt
  if ! cmp -s o1.txt o2.txt; then echo "DIFF on seed $i"; cat in.txt; break; fi
done
```

```python
# gen.py
import random, sys
random.seed(int(sys.argv[1]))
n = random.randint(1, 6)
print(n)
print(*[random.randint(1, 10) for _ in range(n)])
```

Keep tests *tiny* (n ≤ 6, values ≤ 10): the smallest failing case is the easiest to debug by hand.

1.3 When You're Stuck

1.3.1 Constraints → target complexity

Budget ≈ $3 \cdot 10^8$ simple operations per second (less with maps/sets, recursion, cache misses).

n up to	target	typical techniques
8–11	O(n!·n)	all permutations (`next_permutation`), brute force
15–20	$O(2^n \cdot n)$, $O(3^n)$ at 15	bitmask DP, subset enumeration, submask DP
35–45	$O(2^{n/2})$	meet in the middle
50–100	$O(n^4)$, $O(n^3 \log)$	Floyd, flows, small Hungarian, DP with 3–4 dims
300–500	$O(n^3)$	interval DP, Floyd, Gaussian elimination, Hungarian
2000–5000	$O(n^2)$	2D DP, all pairs, $O(n^2)$ with bitset /32 for 10^4–10^5
10^5–$2 \cdot 10^5$	O(n log n), $O(n \log^2 n)$, O(n√n)	sort, BIT/segtree, binary search, Dijkstra, Mo's
10^6	O(n), O(n log n) small const	linear scans, sieve, prefix sums, two pointers, KMP/Z
10^9–10^{18}	O(log n), O(√n), O(cube-root)	math formula, binary search, matrix power, digit DP, factorization

- **Sum of n over tests ≤ X** → per-test complexity can use X. Otherwise multiply by T!
- Two small parameters (e.g. n ≤ 10^5, k ≤ 20) → O(n·k) or $O(n \cdot 2^k)$ DP is intended (ACPC 2022 *City Numbers*: k ≤ 20 colours on a tree).

- A weirdly specific bound is a hint: `n ≤ 15` (bitmask/interval brute), `values ≤ 200` (enumerate the value — ACPC 2018 *Dog Trouble*), `prime factors < 10^6` (trial division works), `p < 10^10, s ≤ 10^5` (s^2 can exceed p).
- Output modulo a prime → counting, combinatorics, DP; answer would be huge otherwise.
- Output a real number with 1e-6 → binary/ternary search on reals, geometry, probability.

1.3.2 Keyword → technique

if the problem says / looks like ...	try	where
minimize the maximum / maximize the minimum	binary search on answer + greedy/BFS check	§2.1
"find the smallest X such that feasible" and feasibility is monotone	binary search on X	§2.1
maximize ratio Σa/Σb	binary search λ: is max Σ(a − λb) ≥ 0 (Dinkelbach)	§2.1
unimodal function of a real variable	ternary search / golden section	§2.1
k-th smallest of something implicit	binary search on value, count ≤ mid	§2.1
subarray sums/xors, count subarrays with property	prefix sums + hashmap / two pointers	§2.2, §2.3
range add many times, query once	difference array	§2.2
sum over all pairs/subarrays of f	contribution technique: count how often each element contributes	§2.2
nearest greater/smaller, "visible", histogram	monotonic stack	§2.3
sliding window min/max	monotonic deque	§2.3
schedule jobs with deadlines/durations	sort by deadline + heap; exchange argument	§2.4
choose k things to maximize something, n large	greedy + heap; check with exchange argument	§2.4
n ≤ 40, subset sums	meet in the middle	§2.5
connectivity under edge deletions, offline	reverse time → DSU additions	§3.1
point update + range query	Fenwick / segment tree	§3.2–3.3
range update + range query	lazy segment tree	§3.3
static range min/gcd	sparse table	§3.4
k-th element in dynamic set, order of key	PBDS ordered set / BIT walk	§3.4
many range queries, offline, no updates, hard to merge	Mo's algorithm	§3.4
count / optimize over sequences, choices at each step	DP; define state = what you need to know about the past	§4.1
subsequence counting (e.g. palindromic subsequences)	interval DP with inclusion–exclusion	§4.1
interleaving two strings, edit distance, LCS	2D DP	§4.1
merge adjacent / parenthesize / split interval	interval DP $O(n^3)$; keep max AND min if signs	§4.1
n ≤ 20 items, choose order/assignment	bitmask DP	§4.2
count numbers in [L, R] with digit property	digit DP	§4.2
tree, choose labels/colours per node with neighbour constraint	tree DP (keep best & second best)	§4.3
answer for every root	rerooting DP	§4.3
dp[i] = min_j (dp[j] + b_j·a_i)	convex hull trick / Li Chao	§4.4
dp[k][i] = min_j dp[k−1][j] + cost(j,i), cost "Monge"	divide & conquer opt / Knuth	§4.4
expected value, probability of winning, optimal stopping	linearity of expectation; DP over states backward	§4.5
turns repeat in a cycle with probabilities	geometric series / solve linear equations	§4.5
two players, optimal play, who wins	win/lose DP, Sprague–Grundy, find pattern by brute force	§4.5
shortest path, unweighted / weights 0–1 / nonneg	BFS / 0-1 BFS / Dijkstra	§5.1
shortest path with extra condition (fuel, horse, key, parity)	Dijkstra on (node, state)	§5.1
distance to nearest of many sources	multi-source BFS/Dijkstra	§5.1
path maximizing the minimum edge/vertex value	binary search + BFS, or max spanning tree, or modified Dijkstra	§5.1
which sums are representable by coins (unbounded)	Dijkstra on residues mod smallest coin	§5.1
minimum ratio spanning tree	binary search λ + MST	§5.2
dependencies / ordering	topological sort, DAG DP	§5.2
each node has one outgoing edge	functional graph: cycles + trees, binary lifting	§5.2
boolean constraints "a or b"	2-SAT	§5.3

if the problem says / looks like ...	try	where
edges whose removal disconnects	bridges / articulation points	§5.3
use every edge exactly once	Euler path (Hierholzer)	§5.3
tree path queries, ancestors, distances	LCA / binary lifting / Euler tour + BIT / HLD	§5.4
count paths in tree with property	centroid decomposition / small-to-large	§5.4
assign workers to jobs one-to-one, min cost	Hungarian / min-cost flow	§6.3
max pairs with compatibility	bipartite matching	§6.2
min #paths covering all vertices of a DAG	n − max matching (split graph)	§6.2
min #paths covering all **edges** of a DAG	min flow with lower bounds = Dilworth on edges	§6.1
cut with costs, "choose set with dependencies, max profit"	min cut / project selection	§6.1
grid with dominoes / chessboard parity	bipartite matching on black/white cells	§6.2
gcd, lcm, divisibility, a·x + b·y = c	ext. gcd, CRT	§7.1–7.2
sum of divisors, factorization of big n	sieve / trial division up to √n / Pollard rho	§7.2
count arrangements, multisets, paths	stars & bars, Catalan, inclusion–exclusion, Burnside	§7.3
linear recurrence with huge n	matrix exponentiation	§7.4
system of linear (mod 2) equations, max xor subset	Gaussian elimination / xor basis	§7.4
count pairs with sum = k for all k, pattern matching counts	FFT / NTT convolution	§7.5
string equality of substrings fast	polynomial hashing	§8.1
pattern occurrences / borders / periods	KMP prefix function, Z-function	§8.1
rotations / cyclic shifts equal	minimal rotation (Booth) as canonical form	§8.2
longest palindrome substring	Manacher	§8.2
many patterns in a text	Aho–Corasick	§8.2
distinct substrings, LCP of suffixes	suffix array + LCP	§8.2
polygon area, orientation, lattice points	shoelace, cross product, Pick	§9.1–9.2
smallest enclosing / outer boundary of points	convex hull	§9.2
interactive: judge answers queries	binary search / information-theoretic planning / gcd tricks	§10.1
evaluate expressions, mini-language	recursive descent parser	§10.2

1.3.3 Stuck-on-an-idea checklist

1. **Re-read the statement.** Underline every constraint. Is something guaranteed (distinct values, connected, sorted, a < b)? That guarantee is usually *used*.
2. **Solve tiny cases by hand** (n = 1, 2, 3) and **write a brute force**; print answers for n = 1..10 and look for a pattern (then search OEIS-style in your head: powers of 2, Catalan, Fibonacci, n^2, C(2n,n)).
3. **What is the answer monotone in?** If "answer ≥ x is feasible" is monotone → binary search. Fixing the answer often turns optimization into a yes/no greedy.
4. **Fix one thing and iterate over it:** fix the maximum element, the left endpoint, the last chosen item, the root, the value of one variable (e.g. enumerate the max time t ≤ 200 then solve the rest).
5. **Sort** the input (by start, end, value, ratio). Many greedy/DP problems become easy after sorting by the right key; find the key with an exchange argument.
6. **Reverse** something: process time backward (deletions → additions), reverse the graph, think about the complement ("at least one" = total − "none").
7. **Change what you iterate over:** over values instead of indices, over divisors instead of multiples (harmonic sum n log n), over the answer instead of the input.
8. **Model as a graph:** states = nodes, moves = edges. Grid + extra state (direction, keys, used power-up) → BFS/Dijkstra on product graph.
9. **Model as a flow/matching** when there are "pairings", "assign each X to one Y", "each used at most once", "minimum number of chains/paths".
10. **Linearity of expectation:** E[sum] = Σ E[indicator]. Never compute the full distribution if only an expectation is asked.
11. **Bound the search:** the answer is small (≤ 60 when doubling, ≤ log n), the number of distinct values is small (≤ √(2n) distinct lengths if Σ = n), only O(√n) distinct `n / i` values.
12. **Look for invariants** (parity, sum mod k, xor) in games and constructive problems.

13. Think about the **special structure:** tree (unique paths, DP), DAG (topo order), bipartite, planar grid, permutation (cycles), convex polygon ($O(n^3)$ DP over vertices).
14. Still stuck after 20–30 min with no progress → switch problems, come back later.

1.3.4 WA / RE / TLE checklist

- **Overflow**: `int * int`, sums of 10^5 values of 10^9, `1 << 40`, `INF + x`. When in doubt, `ll` everywhere.
- **Multi-test state** not reset (globals, adjacency lists, visited arrays, DSU).
- **Off-by-one**: inclusive vs exclusive ranges; 0- vs 1-indexed input; array size `n` vs `n + 1`.
- **Edge cases**: n = 1, empty set, all equal, all negative, answer 0, disconnected graph, self-loops, multi-edges, duplicate points, collinear points.
- **Reading**: multiple values per line, strings with spaces (`getline`), trailing spaces, Windows `\r`.
- **Output**: exact format/capitalisation ("Yes" vs "YES"), precision, one answer per line, `-0.0`.
- **Negative modulo**: `((a % m) + m) % m`. Subtraction in modular arithmetic: `(a - b + MOD) % MOD`.
- **Doubles compared with `==`**; use eps or exact integer arithmetic (cross products in `ll`).
- **Uninitialised** local variables / arrays (globals are zeroed, locals aren't).
- **Recursion depth** (10^6 deep DFS), **stack arrays** too big (`int a[10^7]` inside `main` → use global/vector).
- **TLE**: `endl` flushing, `map` where an array works, passing `vector` by value, O(n) `lower_bound` on `set`, `string +=` in a loop creating copies (`s = s + c` is O(n)), recomputing in loops, too many `long double`.
- **Dijkstra**: skip stale heap entries (`if (d > dist[u]) continue;`), else worst case is quadratic.
- **Comparator** not strict weak ordering → crash in `sort`.
- **Wrong algorithm**: greedy without proof → stress test against brute force.

1.4 ACPC 2016–2024: Every Problem → Technique

Kattis difficulty in brackets. Technique = the intended core idea (my analysis of the statements; `?` = likely but unverified). Use this to calibrate: what does a 4.0 vs 6.5 ACPC problem look like?

year	problem [diff]	core technique
2016	Mirror Images [1.6], Soylent [1.7], Bits [2.2]	implementation
	Wood Cutting [2.5]	sort ascending (shortest processing time first), prefix sums
	Dacey the Dice [3.3]	BFS on (cell, die orientation) — 24 orientations
	Flower Garden [3.6]	prefix of Manhattan distances + sieve for primes
	Palindromic Naming [4.1]	count palindromic subsequences, interval DP $O(n^2)$ mod p (§4.1)
	City Destruction [5.6]	linear DP over buildings with state "was neighbour destroyed before me"
	Modelling Problems [6.8]	parse a mini-language, brute force over unknown 0/1 values
2017	Musical Scales [1.6], Tetration [1.7]	implementation / math ($x = a^{1/a}$)
	Quantum Superposition [2.2]	DAG DP: set of reachable path lengths (bitset), combine two sets
	Anthony and Diablo [2.3]	geometry: max area for perimeter is a circle
	Divide by 100 [3.2]	big-number string manipulation
	Concentration [4.8]	probability / game simulation reasoning ?
	Lane Switching [5.5]	maximize the minimum (bottleneck path) over intervals: Dijkstra/BFS ?
	Maximal Sequences [6.2]	offline by start index; ordered set of next occurrences per value; check first m+1
	Matchings [7.5]	2-D pattern matching counts via FFT convolution, one FFT per colour (§7.5)
2018	Early Winter [2.0], Eating Out [2.5]	implementation / pigeonhole counting
	Arachnophobia [4.0]	multi-source Dijkstra from spiders + binary search D + Dijkstra s→t
	Dog Trouble [5.8]	enumerate max time t (≤ 200), assignment (Hungarian) maximizing Σt_i (§6.3)
	PUBNite [5.8]	geometry + binary/ternary search on time

year	problem [diff]	core technique
	Exploding Kittens [6.4]	simulation, skipping irrelevant cards ?
	Homework [6.5]	string interleaving DP O(len1·len2) (bitset if tight)
	Trimming Convex Polygons [6.9]	DP over convex polygon vertices $O(n^3)$ (fix first kept vertex, triangle fan)
2020	Test Drive [1.9], Laptop Stickers [1.9], Warring Scoring [2.8]	implementation
	Path Crossings [2.9]	hashing (x,y,t) / sort events
	Straights [2.9]	greedy on value counts
	Listen To Your Boss [3.9]	tree ancestor queries: Euler tour tin/tout (§5.4)
	Wormhole Extreme!!! [4.4]	kinematics; minimum initial velocity via v^2 recursion / binary search
	Hired Help [5.5]	binary search #employees + greedy deadline check
	Monochromatic Minesweeper [6.2]	constructive / search with pruning ?
	Password Rotation [6.3]	canonical form = min rotation of s and reverse(s) (Booth), hash set (§8.2)
	Wrapping Trees [7.3]	fractal → convex hull of the self-similar set; geometry
	Best Investing [7.8]	math / greedy over deposit–withdraw schedule ?
2021	Finding An A [1.2], GCVWR [1.4], Square Peg [1.5], Simone [1.8], Colour Wars [2.3]	implementation
	Snakes and Masters [2.9]	Fibonacci DP mod 10^6
	Bitmask [3.1]	string/bit matching with DP ?
	Menu Updates [3.3]	maintain smallest available number: set/heap
	Associative Exponents [3.4]	compare $a^{b\hat{}c}$ vs $(a^b)^c \Leftrightarrow b^c$ vs b·c, careful with overflow
	Ghostbusters 3 [3.8]	non-crossing assignment: sort + greedy/DP ?
	Wonky Pizza [4.2]	polar area $\int r^2/2\, d\theta$ closed form + binary search the angle
	Beep Code [4.6]	bit decomposition of a sum of square waves; reason level by level
	Balls and Bins [5.1]	optimal-stopping expected-value DP over (#bins with 1, #bins with 2) (§4.5)
	Swapping Places [8.1]	constructive: permutation routing on spanning tree, process leaves first
	Compression [8.2]	DP over block boundaries with careful cost precomputation
2022	Undead or Alive [1.3], Ordinals [1.8], Count Doubles [1.8]	implementation
	Contingency Planning [2.1]	$\Sigma_k\ n!/(n-k)!$ with cap
	Simple Factoring [2.4]	discriminant $b^2 - 4ac$ is a perfect square
	Maximum Fix [3.4]	each element votes for the one shift that fixes it; count array
	Supply Routes [3.5]	offline: reverse edge deletions → DSU unions (§3.1)
	Fight to Survive [3.8]	greedy / simulation ?
	City Numbers [4.4]	tree DP dp[v][colour], keep best & second best child value (§4.3)
	Long Walk [5.5]	implicit graph $i \leftrightarrow 2i \bmod 2^n$: bit manipulation, LCA-like on binary strings
	Braaaains [5.8]	Frobenius/coin reachability: Dijkstra on residues mod smallest size (§5.1)
	Tricky Factoring [6.7]	factor a, c (primes $< 10^6$), enumerate divisor pairs, count distinct b = dg + ef
	Maximal Parentheticals [8.0]	interval DP over expression tracking max and min (signs flip)
	Escape Routes [8.3]	min #paths covering all DAG edges = min flow with lower bounds (§6.1)
2023	Buildin' Fences [1.5]	implementation
	Flying Straight [3.0]	trigonometry (arc vs tangent)

year	problem [diff]	core technique
	Buildin' Roads [3.3]	minimum ratio spanning tree: binary search λ + MST (§2.1, §5.2)
	OBD Codes [3.9]	pattern matching on event streams ?
	Counting Cacti [4.0]	grid parsing + flood fill components
	Outlaw Numbers [4.0]	aliquot sequence: sum of proper divisors via factorization, ≤ 32 steps
	Wrangler Rating [4.5]	careful simulation of rules
	Circuit Game [5.2]	graph connectivity under switch removal + budget ?
	Dice Tables [5.2]	counting multisets (stars and bars) over overlapping face ranges, mod 10^9+9
	Desert Strike [5.4]	lattice counting of a rasterized rotated square (math)
	High Noon Language Showdown [5.5]	brute force over n with exact integer ceil(log2)
	Temporal Turmoil [6.7]	clock-hand alignment math with exact fractions
	Horse Snatchers [6.8]	binary search horse speed + Dijkstra on (node, has horse)
	Gunslingers [7.8]	probability DP over survivor sets with cyclic turns (geometric series)
2024	Snowfall [1.6], Melting Snow [1.7], Handheld Fan [2.2]	implementation
	Wrapping Snowballs [3.5]	?
	Alpine Agility [3.8]	grid DP (moves S/E/SE)
	Slippery Floor [3.8]	BFS where a move slides until hitting an obstacle
	Topographic Isolation [4.0]	monotonic stack: nearest $\geq$ on each side (§2.3)
	A Little to the Right [4.2]	count distinct sorted orders among properties with all-distinct values
	Hockey Fans [4.4]	binary search on D + greedy left-to-right placement
	Uniform Variation [4.7]	brute force: groups of all-different are ≤ 4; enumerate small subsets
	Snow Way Out [6.7]	interactive, 6 comparisons on 10×10 grid: offline minimax search for a strategy
	Four Questions [7.1]	interactive: $s^2 \bmod p \Rightarrow p$ divides $s^2 - r$; gcd of such values (§10.1)
	Speedy Slopes [7.2]	shortest path with speed state on grid ?

Patterns to take away

- Binary search on the answer appears almost every year (Arachnophobia, Hired Help, Hockey Fans, Horse Snatchers, Buildin' Roads).
- Dijkstra variants: multi-source, state-augmented, residue graph (Braaaains).
- Probability/expected value DP appears most years at 5–8 difficulty.
- One flow/matching problem every year or two (Dog Trouble, Escape Routes).
- Interactive problems appeared in 2024 (two of them) — read §10.1 before the contest.
- Number theory with "all prime factors $< 10^6$" or big-number twists.

2. Core Techniques

2.1 Binary Search, Ternary Search, Parametric Search

2.1.1 Integer binary search on the answer

Use when `ok(x)` is monotone: `false false ... false true true ...`. Write the invariant, not a formula you half-remember: **`lo` is always bad, `hi` is always good.**

```
// smallest x in (lo, hi] with ok(x) true; requires ok(hi) true, ok(lo) false (lo may be a sentinel)
template <class F> ll firstTrue(ll lo, ll hi, F ok) {
    while (hi - lo > 1) {
        ll mid = lo + (hi - lo) / 2;
        (ok(mid) ? hi : lo) = mid;
    }
    return hi;
}
// largest good x for "true ... true false ... false": lastTrue = firstTrue of !ok, minus 1
```

- Bounds: pick `lo` = something surely infeasible (often `-1` or `0`), `hi` = surely feasible (`1e18`, `2e9`). Check that `ok` never overflows at `hi` (e.g. `mid * cnt` with `mid = 1e18` → use `__int128` or early exit).
- **Maximize the minimum** (e.g. Hockey Fans, ACPC 2024: largest D such that M non-overlapping windows of length S all have values ≥ D): `ok(D)` = greedy scan left to right taking a window as soon as the last S values are all ≥ D. Monotone because a smaller D is easier.
- **Minimize the maximum** (split array into k parts minimizing max sum; minimize max edge on a path): `ok(X)` = greedy "how many parts do I need with cap X" ≤ k.
- **k-th smallest of an implicit set** (k-th smallest pairwise sum/difference, k-th fraction): binary search value v, count elements ≤ v (two pointers on sorted arrays is usually O(n)).
- **Binary search + graph** (Arachnophobia, Horse Snatchers): fix the parameter, then run BFS/Dijkstra on the allowed subgraph and check if the target is reachable within the time limit. Complexity × log(range).
- Searching over sorted *candidate* values (e.g. distinct edge weights) instead of the whole range keeps the answer exact and iterations ≤ log n.

2.1.2 Real-valued binary search

```
// sketch: ok(mid) = your feasibility test
double lo = 0, hi = 1e9;
for (int it = 0; it < 100; ++it) {   // 100 halvings: 2^-100 relative; never loop on hi-lo>eps
    double mid = (lo + hi) / 2;
    if (ok(mid)) hi = mid; else lo = mid;
}
```

Fixed iteration count avoids infinite loops caused by precision. 60 iterations are enough for 1e-9 relative on [0, 1e9]; cost is usually negligible.

2.1.3 Ternary search (unimodal functions)

```
// maximum of strictly unimodal f on [lo, hi] (reals)
template <class F> double ternaryMax(double lo, double hi, F f) {
    for (int it = 0; it < 200; ++it) {
        double m1 = lo + (hi - lo) / 3, m2 = hi - (hi - lo) / 3;
        if (f(m1) < f(m2)) lo = m1; else hi = m2;
    }
    return (lo + hi) / 2;
}
// integers: shrink while hi - lo > 2, then check lo..hi directly
template <class F> ll ternaryMaxInt(ll lo, ll hi, F f) {
    while (hi - lo > 2) {
        ll m1 = lo + (hi - lo) / 3, m2 = hi - (hi - lo) / 3;
        if (f(m1) < f(m2)) lo = m1 + 1; else hi = m2;
    }
    ll best = lo;
    for (ll x = lo; x <= hi; ++x) if (f(x) > f(best)) best = x;
    return best;
}
```

- Integer version fails with plateaus (f(m1) == f(m2) not at the max). If f can be flat, binary search on the sign of `f(x+1) - f(x)` instead (valid when f is concave: differences are non-increasing).

- Convex functions: sums of convex functions are convex (e.g. $\Sigma|x - a_i|$, Σ dist(P(t), Q_i) for linear motion). Distance between two points moving linearly over time is convex in t → ternary search on time.
- Nested ternary search works for functions convex in 2 variables (e.g. Fermat point, smallest enclosing circle centre) but is slow: 100×100 evaluations.

2.1.4 Parametric search / fractional programming

Maximize $\Sigma a_i / \Sigma b_i$ over feasible sets S ($b > 0$). The answer $\geq \lambda$ iff $\max_S \Sigma(a_i - \lambda b_i) \geq 0$. So binary search λ and solve the *unweighted* problem with weights $a_i - \lambda b_i$:

- Choose exactly k items: sort by $a_i - \lambda b_i$, take top k.
- Spanning tree minimizing Σcost/Σgain (ACPC 2023 *Buildin' Roads*): min ratio ⇔ binary search λ, MST with weights cost $- \lambda \cdot$gain, check total ≤ 0.
- Cycle with maximum mean (Σw/len): binary search λ, look for positive cycle with weights $w - \lambda$ (Bellman–Ford).

Dinkelbach converges faster: start $\lambda = 0$; repeat: $S = \text{argmax } \Sigma(a - \lambda b)$; $\lambda = \Sigma_S a / \Sigma_S b$; until no improvement (usually < 10 iterations).

2.1.5 Binary lifting search ("walk down powers of two")

When you can test "is the answer $\geq$ pos + 2^k" incrementally (Fenwick tree prefix walk, binary lifting on ancestors, sparse table), descend over k from high to low instead of a separate binary search — saves a log factor. See BIT `lower_bound` (§3.2) and LCA (§5.4).

2.1.6 Parallel binary search (offline, many queries)

Q queries each need "first time t when condition holds" where the structure evolves over time (e.g. first time u,v connected after edge additions; first time a sum reaches a threshold). Do log T rounds: in each round sort queries by their current `mid`, replay the events once from the start, and answer all `ok(mid)` checks along the way. Cost: O((T + Q) log T × cost of one event).

2.2 Prefix Sums, Difference Arrays, Sweep Line, Contribution

2.2.1 Prefix sums (1D/2D) and difference arrays

```
// 1D: p[i] = a[0] + ... + a[i-1]; sum of a[l..r] = p[r+1] - p[l]
// 2D: P[i][j] = sum of a[0..i-1][0..j-1]
struct Pref2D {
    vector<vector<ll>> P;
    Pref2D(const vector<vector<ll>>& a) {
        int n = a.size(), m = a[0].size();
        P.assign(n + 1, vector<ll>(m + 1, 0));
        rep(i, 0, n) rep(j, 0, m) P[i + 1][j + 1] = a[i][j] + P[i][j + 1] + P[i + 1][j] - P[i][j];
    }
    ll query(int r1, int c1, int r2, int c2) {  // inclusive rectangle
        return P[r2 + 1][c2 + 1] - P[r1][c2 + 1] - P[r2 + 1][c1] + P[r1][c1];
    }
};
```

- **Difference array:** add v to a[l..r] ⇒ `d[l] += v; d[r+1] -= v;` then prefix-sum d once. 2D: `d[r1][c1] += v; d[r1][c2+1] -= v; d[r2+1][c1] -= v; d[r2+1][c2+1] += v`.
- Adding an arithmetic progression to ranges: apply difference twice (second-order difference).
- **Count subarrays with sum = k:** iterate prefix p, `ans += cnt[p - k]; cnt[p]++` (hashmap; start with `cnt[0] = 1`). Same for xor (`p ^ k`), and for "sum divisible by m" (`cnt[p mod m]`).
- **Longest subarray with sum ≤ k (non-negative values)**: two pointers. With negatives: prefix + monotonic stack / sorted prefix minima + binary search.
- **Prefix of a function over a cycle** (rotations, circular arrays): double the array, take windows of length n.

2.2.2 Coordinate compression

```
// sketch: vals = every coordinate that matters
vector<ll> xs = vals;                       // all coordinates that matter
sort(all(xs)); xs.erase(unique(all(xs)), xs.end());
auto id = [&](ll x) { return int(lower_bound(all(xs), x) - xs.begin()); };
```

For intervals on a compressed axis, remember that compressed index i represents the *point* xs[i]; the gap between xs[i] and xs[i+1] has length `xs[i+1] - xs[i]` (needed for union-of-intervals length / area).

2.2.3 Sweep line

Turn geometry/intervals into **events sorted by coordinate**, process with a data structure.

- **Max overlapping intervals:** events (l, +1), (r, −1); sort; for closed intervals put +1 before −1 at equal coordinate.
- **Union length of intervals:** sort by l, merge greedily.
- **Area of union of rectangles:** sweep x; segment tree over compressed y storing "count covered > 0 length" (classic: node stores `cnt` and `covered len`, no push-down needed).
- **Pairs of intersecting segments / closest pair:** sweep with `set` ordered by current y (rarely needed at ACPC).
- **Offline queries:** sort queries together with updates by coordinate/time; answer each query when the sweep reaches it (e.g. "count points with x ≤ X and y ≤ Y" → sort by x, BIT on y).
- **Events at same coordinate:** decide the order explicitly (insertions before queries? removals first?) — this is the #1 sweep bug.

```
// sketch: max number of simultaneously active closed intervals [l, r]
vector<pair<ll,int>> ev;
for (auto [l, r] : iv) { ev.push_back({l, -1}); ev.push_back({r, +1}); } // -1 = open sorts first
sort(all(ev));
int cur = 0, best = 0;
for (auto [x, t] : ev) { cur -= t; best = max(best, cur); }
```

2.2.4 Contribution technique (sum over all subsets/subarrays/pairs)

Instead of enumerating structures, ask: **for each element, in how many structures does it contribute, and how much?**

- Σ over all subarrays of sum = Σ a_i · (i+1)·(n−i) (0-indexed).
- Σ over all subarrays of max: a_i is the max of subarrays with l ∈ (L_i, i], r ∈ [i, R_i) where L_i = previous index with value ≥ a_i (strict on one side, non-strict on the other to avoid double counting ties), R_i = next index with value > a_i. Contribution a_i·(i − L_i)·(R_i − i). Use monotonic stack (§2.3).
- Σ over pairs |a_i − a_j|: sort; a_i contributes `a_i·i − (sum of previous)`.
- Σ over all subsets of max: sort; a_i is the max in 2^i subsets.
- Σ of path lengths over all pairs in a tree: edge (parent, v) is used by sz[v]·(n − sz[v]) pairs.
- Expected value versions: same with probabilities (linearity of expectation, §4.5).

2.2.5 Offline tricks summary

- Answer queries in a convenient order (sorted by right endpoint, by threshold, by time) and restore original order at the end — store the query index.
- Reverse time for deletions (DSU can't delete, but can add).
- Divide & conquer over time / CDQ: split operations, handle "left half updates → right half queries" with a sort + BIT.

2.3 Two Pointers, Monotonic Stack, Monotonic Deque

2.3.1 Two pointers / sliding window

Valid when, for each left end `l`, the best/maximal right end `r(l)` is non-decreasing in `l` (window property is monotone: shrinking a valid window keeps it valid).

```
// longest window with at most k distinct values
int longestKDistinct(const vector<int>& a, int k) {
    unordered_map<int, int> cnt;
    int best = 0;
    for (int l = 0, r = 0; r < sz(a); ++r) {
        cnt[a[r]]++;
        while (sz(cnt) > k) { if (--cnt[a[l]] == 0) cnt.erase(a[l]); ++l; }
        best = max(best, r - l + 1);
    }
    return best;
}
```

- Count windows satisfying a monotone property: for each r, all l' ≥ l(r) work → `ans += r - l + 1`.
- "Exactly k" = atMost(k) − atMost(k−1).
- Two sorted arrays: pairs with a_i + b_j ≤ X — one pointer forward on a, one backward on b.
- **Does not work with negative numbers for sums** (window sum isn't monotone) — use prefix sums + sorted structure instead.

2.3.2 Monotonic stack: nearest greater / smaller

```cpp
// prv[i] = largest j < i with a[j] >= a[i] (or -1); nxt[i] = smallest j > i with a[j] > a[i] (or n)
// (>= on one side, > on the other: ties are counted exactly once in "subarrays where a[i] is max")
void nearestGreater(const vector<ll>& a, vector<int>& prv, vector<int>& nxt) {
    int n = sz(a); prv.assign(n, -1); nxt.assign(n, n);
    vector<int> st;
    rep(i, 0, n) {
        while (!st.empty() && a[st.back()] < a[i]) { nxt[st.back()] = i; st.pop_back(); }
        prv[i] = st.empty() ? -1 : st.back();
        st.push_back(i);
    }
}
```

Uses: largest rectangle in histogram (nearest smaller on both sides, area $h_i \cdot (R - L - 1)$); sum of subarray maxima/minima (contribution, §2.2); ACPC 2024 *Topographic Isolation* (for each peak, nearest index on the left and right with height ≥ peak: answer = min distance); visibility ("how many people can i see"); next greater element in a circular array (iterate 2n).

Maximal all-ones rectangle in a 0/1 grid: for each row keep `h[j]` = consecutive ones above; run histogram per row. O(nm).

2.3.3 Monotonic deque: sliding window min/max

```cpp
// mins[i] = min(a[i-k+1..i]) for i >= k-1
vector<ll> slidingMin(const vector<ll>& a, int k) {
    deque<int> dq; vector<ll> res;
    rep(i, 0, sz(a)) {
        while (!dq.empty() && a[dq.back()] >= a[i]) dq.pop_back();
        dq.push_back(i);
        if (dq.front() <= i - k) dq.pop_front();
        if (i >= k - 1) res.push_back(a[dq.front()]);
    }
    return res;
}
```

- **DP optimisation:** `dp[i] = min_{i-k ≤ j < i} dp[j] + c_i` → keep deque of j by dp value. Also `dp[i] = max_{j} (dp[j] - f(j)) + g(i)` with a sliding range of j.
- 2D sliding window min: apply 1D on rows, then on columns of the result.
- Shortest subarray with sum ≥ K with negative numbers: deque over prefix sums (increasing), pop front while `p[i] - p[front] ≥ K`.

2.3.4 Other amortised patterns

- **Stack simulation**: bracket matching, "remove adjacent equal pairs", evaluating expressions (shunting-yard).
- **Next pointer / "jump" with path compression**: "find next unvisited index ≥ i" — DSU where `nxt[i] = i+1` after visiting i; O(α) per query. Great for "paint ranges, each cell painted once" problems.
- **Small-to-large merging**: merge smaller set into larger → O(n log n) total insertions (§3.4).

2.4 Greedy and Exchange Arguments

A greedy is only as good as its proof. Standard proof: take an optimal solution that differs from greedy at the first position; **swap** to agree with greedy without making it worse. If you can't prove it, stress test against a brute force (§1.2) before submitting.

2.4.1 Finding the sort key by exchange

Two adjacent items i, j in an order; compare cost(…i j…) vs cost(…j i…). The difference only involves i and j ⇒ sort by that comparison.

problem	key
minimise Σ completion times (1 machine)	ascending processing time (SPT) — ACPC 2016 *Wood Cutting*
minimise $\Sigma w_i \cdot C_i$	ascending t_i / w_i, i.e. compare `t_i*w_j < t_j*w_i` (integers!)
minimise max lateness	ascending deadline (EDF)
concatenate strings to get smallest string	`a + b < b + a`
tasks with requirement r_i and cost c_i (need ≥ r to start, lose c)	descending $r_i - c_i$
two machines, each job on A then B (Johnson)	jobs with a<b first by a ascending, then others by b descending

Always compare with cross-multiplication in integers instead of dividing.

2.4.2 Interval greedies

- **Max number of disjoint intervals:** sort by right end, take if start > last end.
- **Min points to stab all intervals:** sort by right end; if interval not stabbed, put a point at its right end.
- **Min intervals to cover [0, L]:** sort by left; repeatedly among intervals with left ≤ covered, take the one with max right.
- **Partition intervals into min number of "rooms":** sort by start, min-heap of end times; answer = max overlap.
- **Assign intervals to k machines maximizing count:** sort by end, multiset of machine free times; assign to the machine with the latest free time ≤ start.

2.4.3 Deadline scheduling

Unit jobs with deadlines, maximise #jobs (or profit): sort by profit desc, place each job in the latest free slot ≤ its deadline (DSU "next free slot" trick, §3.1). Or: sort by deadline, push profits into a min-heap, pop the smallest whenever heap size > deadline.

Jobs with durations and deadlines, maximise count (Moore–Hodgson):

```
// jobs (deadline, duration); maximum number completed on time
int maxOnTime(vector<pair<ll,ll>> jobs) {
    sort(all(jobs));
    priority_queue<ll> pq; ll t = 0;
    for (auto [d, p] : jobs) {
        pq.push(p); t += p;
        if (t > d) { t -= pq.top(); pq.pop(); }   // drop the longest job so far
    }
    return sz(pq);
}
```

Feasibility check with deadlines (ACPC 2020 *Hired Help*: can we form k groups of K unit jobs?): a set of unit jobs is schedulable on c machines iff for every t, #jobs with deadline ≤ t is ≤ c·t. Combine with binary search on k and pick the jobs with the *latest* deadlines.

2.4.4 Heap greedies

- **Merge costs (Huffman):** always merge two smallest; total cost Σ.
- **Regret / "undo" greedy:** buy low sell high with one transaction per day: min-heap; for each price p: if `top < p` then `profit += p - top`, pop, and push p (this copy lets the sale be "undone" later); then always push p. Same idea: choose k non-adjacent elements with max sum — take max, replace it with (left + right − it) node, linked list.
- **k largest sums / k best combinations:** heap of states with "next" transitions (e.g. pairs (i, j) of two sorted arrays, push (i+1, j) and (i, j+1) with a visited set).

2.4.5 Other common greedy facts

- To maximise Σ a_i·b_{π(i)}: sort both same direction (rearrangement inequality); to minimise: opposite directions.
- Median minimises Σ|x − a_i|; mean minimises Σ(x − a_i)².
- Making an array non-decreasing with ±1 ops (min cost) → slope trick / median heap.
- Lexicographically smallest answer: build character by character, at each step try the smallest choice and check feasibility of completing (feasibility check is often a simple counting argument).
- Coin change greedy only works for canonical systems (1,5,10,25…); for arbitrary coins use DP.
- Pair the largest with the smallest (boats/teams with capacity): sort + two pointers.

2.5 Complete Search, Meet in the Middle, Square Root, Randomization

2.5.1 Brute force done right

- Enumerate subsets: `for (int m = 0; m < (1 << n); ++m)`. Permutations: sort, then `do { } while (next_permutation(all(p)));` (n ≤ 10: 3.6M perms).
- **Backtracking with pruning:** order choices (most constrained first), prune with an optimistic bound (current + best possible remaining ≤ best found ⇒ stop), memoize repeated states.
- **Iterate over the small dimension:** if one of the parameters is ≤ 20–200 (number of colours, max value, number of properties), loop over it explicitly.
- **Search the answer space instead of the input space** when the answer is small (e.g. answer ≤ 60 because values double).
- Before brute forcing, count states × transitions and compare with $3 \cdot 10^8$.

2.5.2 Meet in the middle

Split n ≤ 40 items into halves, enumerate $2^{n/2}$ each, combine with sort + two pointers/binary search/hash map.

```
// number of subsets with sum <= S (n <= 40)
ll countSubsets(const vector<ll>& a, ll S) {
    int n = sz(a), h = n / 2;
    auto gen = [&](int l, int r) {
        vector<ll> s = {0};
        for (int i = l; i < r; ++i) {
            int k = sz(s);
            rep(j, 0, k) s.push_back(s[j] + a[i]);
        }
        sort(all(s)); return s;
    };
    vector<ll> L = gen(0, h), R = gen(h, n);
    ll cnt = 0; int j = sz(R) - 1;
    for (ll x : L) {                        // L ascending -> pointer in R only moves down
        while (j >= 0 && x + R[j] > S) --j;
        cnt += j + 1;
    }
    return cnt;
}
```

Also: 4-sum = pair sums of two halves; bidirectional BFS on huge implicit graphs (puzzle states) — expand from both ends, stop when frontiers meet.

2.5.3 Square root decomposition

- **Blocks of size B ≈ √n:** each block stores an aggregate (+ lazy tag). Update/query touch O(n/B) full blocks + O(B) loose elements. Handy when the operation is weird (e.g. "add x to range, count elements < y in range": keep each block sorted → O(√n log n)).
- **Heavy/light by frequency:** values occurring > √n times are "heavy" (at most √n of them) → precompute for heavy, brute force for light.
- **Σ of sizes = n ⇒ at most O(√n) distinct sizes.** (Knapsack with Σ w = n has O(√n) distinct weights → bounded knapsack per distinct weight.)
- **Divisor/quotient blocks:** `n / i` takes O(√n) distinct values; iterate blocks:

```
// sum_{i=1}^{n} f(n / i) grouped: for each block [l, r], n / i == q
ll sumQuotients(ll n) {
    ll res = 0;
    for (ll l = 1, r; l <= n; l = r + 1) {
        ll q = n / l; r = n / q;
        res += (r - l + 1) * q;     // replace q by f(q), (r-l+1) by the weight of [l, r]
    }
    return res;
}
```

- **Mo's algorithm** for offline range queries: §3.4.
- **Rebuild periodically:** buffer updates; every √q updates rebuild the static structure; queries check the static structure + the buffer.

2.5.4 Randomization

- **Random shuffle** before inserting into structures that degrade on sorted input (treap keys, BST, hull insertion).
- **Random sampling** to find a majority/frequent element: an element occupying ≥ 1/k of the array is hit with probability ≥ 1/k per sample; 30·k samples → failure ≈ e^{-30}.
- **Hashing with random base/mod** (§8.1); **xor-hashing of sets/multisets**: assign each value a random 64-bit number; set equality ⇔ xor (or sum) of hashes equal. Subarray is a permutation of 1..k ⇔ sum of hashes of subarray = prefix-hash of {1..k}.
- **Random restarts / simulated annealing** for optimization problems with no clear structure (last resort; tune by time limit with `clock()`).
- `mt19937_64 rng(seed)`; never `rand()` (max 32767 on some platforms).

2.5.5 Iterative deepening / search with memo

- Game/puzzle with small depth: IDDFS or BFS over states stored in hash map (encode state into a 64-bit integer).
- **Memoized recursion over states** = DP. If the state space is unclear, write the recursive brute force, then add a `map<State, Answer>` and see if it's fast enough.

2.6 Bit Manipulation and Bitset

2.6.1 Tricks

expression	meaning
`x & -x`	lowest set bit
`x & (x - 1)`	clear lowest set bit; `== 0` ⇔ x is a power of two (x > 0)
`__builtin_popcountll(x)`	number of set bits
`__builtin_ctzll(x)` / `__builtin_clzll(x)`	trailing / leading zeros (undefined for 0!)
`63 - __builtin_clzll(x)`	floor(log2 x) (`__lg(x)` also works)
`x >> k & 1`	k-th bit
`x ^ (1LL << k)`	toggle k-th bit
`(1LL << n) - 1`	mask of n ones
`a + b == (a ^ b) + 2 * (a & b)`	sum decomposes into xor + carries
`a ^ b ^ b == a`	xor cancels; prefix xor gives range xor

```cpp
// iterate all submasks of mask (descending), including 0: total over all masks is 3^n
void subs(int mask) {
    for (int s = mask; ; s = (s - 1) & mask) {
        // use s
        if (s == 0) break;
    }
}
// iterate all supersets of mask within n bits
void supers(int mask, int n) {
    for (int s = mask; s < (1 << n); s = (s + 1) | mask) { /* use s */ }
}
// next mask with the same popcount (Gosper's hack)
ll nextSamePop(ll x) { ll c = x & -x, r = x + c; return (((r ^ x) >> 2) / c) | r; }
```

2.6.2 XOR facts

- XOR of 0..n: `n % 4 == 0 ? n : n % 4 == 1 ? 1 : n % 4 == 2 ? n + 1 : 0`.
- Maximum xor of two numbers in a set: binary trie, greedily go to the opposite bit (O(30) per query).
- Maximum xor of any subset / k-th xor / "is x representable": **linear basis** (§7.4).
- Per-bit independence: many problems on sums of xors/ands/ors split into 30 independent problems, one per bit (count pairs with bit k set in a_i ^ a_j = cnt0·cnt1).
- `a | b` and `a & b`: `a + b = (a | b) + (a & b)`.

2.6.3 Bitset

`bitset<N>` operations are N/64 word ops — 64× speedup for boolean DP.

```cpp
// subset-sum reachability up to MAXS: O(n * MAXS / 64)
const int MAXS = 100001;
bitset<MAXS> reachable(const vector<int>& w) {
    bitset<MAXS> b; b[0] = 1;
    for (int x : w) b |= b << x;
    return b;
}
```

- Transitive closure / reachability in a DAG: `reach[v] |= reach[u]` in reverse topo order: O(n·m/64).
- Counting triangles: for each edge (u,v): `(adj[u] & adj[v]).count()`.
- Sets of reachable path lengths in a DAG (ACPC 2017 *Quantum Superposition*): `len[v] |= len[u] << 1`.
- O(n^2) DP where the transition is an OR/AND over a row (LCS-like boolean, interleaving check like ACPC 2018 *Homework*) can often be done row-by-row with shifts.
- `_Find_first()`, `_Find_next(i)` iterate set bits fast. Size must be a compile-time constant; for dynamic sizes pick the max or template over sizes.

2.6.4 Gray code

`g = i ^ (i >> 1)`: consecutive values differ in one bit — enumerate subsets toggling one element at a time (useful when add/remove of an item is O(1) but recomputation is expensive).

3. Data Structures

3.1 Disjoint Set Union

```
struct DSU {
    vector<int> p;                      // p[x] < 0: x is root, size = -p[x]
    DSU(int n) : p(n, -1) {}
    int find(int x) { return p[x] < 0 ? x : p[x] = find(p[x]); }
    bool same(int a, int b) { return find(a) == find(b); }
    int size(int x) { return -p[find(x)]; }
    bool unite(int a, int b) {
        a = find(a), b = find(b);
        if (a == b) return false;
        if (p[a] > p[b]) swap(a, b);     // union by size
        p[a] += p[b]; p[b] = a;
        return true;
    }
};
```

Recursion depth is O(log n) thanks to union by size, so `find` is safe even for $n = 10^6$.

3.1.1 Uses

- Connected components online under edge additions; Kruskal MST (§5.2); cycle detection in undirected graphs (`unite` returns false).
- **Offline deletions** (ACPC 2022 *Supply Routes*): read all operations, start from the final graph (all never-deleted edges), process operations in reverse: a deletion becomes an addition, queries are answered in reverse and output reversed.
- **"Next free slot" pointer jumping:** `nxt = DSU` where after using slot i you link $i \to i+1$; `find(i)` gives the first free slot $\geq i$. Paint-the-range problems become $O(n\,\alpha)$.
- Track per-component aggregates (sum, min, count of something) in arrays indexed by root; merge them in `unite`.
- Bipartiteness / parity constraints online: DSU with parity (below).
- Process edges in sorted order of weight to answer "max edge on path / min bottleneck" queries offline (Kruskal reconstruction tree idea: when a union happens at weight w, all pairs between the two components have bottleneck w).

3.1.2 DSU with parity / potential (weighted DSU)

Maintains `d[x]` = value(x) − value(root) for relations like "x and y differ by w" or parity "x and y have different colours".

```
struct WDSU {
    vector<int> p; vector<ll> d;        // d[x] = val[x] - val[parent chain root]
    WDSU(int n) : p(n, -1), d(n, 0) {}
    int find(int x) {
        if (p[x] < 0) return x;
        int r = find(p[x]);
        d[x] += d[p[x]]; p[x] = r;      // d[p[x]] is already relative to r
        return r;
    }
    // add constraint val[b] - val[a] = w; returns false on contradiction
    bool unite(int a, int b, ll w) {
        int ra = find(a), rb = find(b);
        if (ra == rb) return d[b] - d[a] == w;
        if (p[ra] > p[rb]) { swap(ra, rb); swap(a, b); w = -w; }
        // attach rb under ra: val[rb] - val[ra] = d[a] + w - d[b]
        p[ra] += p[rb]; p[rb] = ra; d[rb] = d[a] + w - d[b];
        return true;
    }
    ll diff(int a, int b) { find(a); find(b); return d[b] - d[a]; }  // assumes same set
};
```

For parity, use w ∈ {0,1} and compare `(d[b] - d[a]) & 1` (or replace + by xor).

3.1.3 DSU with rollback (for offline dynamic connectivity / divide & conquer)

No path compression; `undo()` pops the last union. Each `find` is O(log n).

```
struct RollbackDSU {
    vector<int> p; vector<pair<int,int>> st;   // (attached root, old parent size)
    int comps;
    RollbackDSU(int n) : p(n, -1), comps(n) {}
    int find(int x) { while (p[x] >= 0) x = p[x]; return x; }
```

```
    bool unite(int a, int b) {
        a = find(a), b = find(b);
        if (a == b) { st.push_back({-1, -1}); return false; }
        if (p[a] > p[b]) swap(a, b);
        st.push_back({b, p[b]});
        p[a] += p[b]; p[b] = a; --comps;
        return true;
    }
    void undo() {
        auto [b, sb] = st.back(); st.pop_back();
        if (b < 0) return;
        int a = p[b]; p[b] = sb; p[a] -= sb; ++comps;
    }
};
```

Offline dynamic connectivity: each edge is alive during a time interval; insert the interval into a segment tree over time (O(log T) nodes); DFS the segment tree, `unite` on entry, `undo` on exit, answer queries at leaves. O(m log T log n).

3.2 Fenwick Tree (BIT)

Point update, prefix query, O(log n), tiny constant. Works for any **invertible** operation (sum, xor) for range queries; for max/min only prefix queries with non-decreasing updates.

```
// [stress-tested] 0-indexed interface, internally 1-indexed
struct BIT {
    int n; vector<ll> t;
    BIT(int n) : n(n), t(n + 1, 0) {}
    void add(int i, ll v) { for (++i; i <= n; i += i & -i) t[i] += v; }
    ll pref(int i) { ll s = 0; for (; i > 0; i -= i & -i) s += t[i]; return s; }  // sum [0, i)
    ll sum(int l, int r) { return pref(r) - pref(l); }                            // sum [l, r)
    // smallest idx such that pref(idx + 1) >= k (all values must be >= 0); returns n if none
    int lower_bound(ll k) {
        int pos = 0;
        for (int pw = 1 << __lg(max(n, 1)); pw; pw >>= 1)
            if (pos + pw <= n && t[pos + pw] < k) { pos += pw; k -= t[pos]; }
        return pos;
    }
};
```

- **Order statistics:** BIT over compressed values with counts; `lower_bound(k)` = k-th smallest (1-based k). Insert/erase = `add(v, ±1)`.
- **Count inversions:** iterate from left, `ans += i - pref(a[i] + 1)` (number of previous elements > a[i]), then `add(a[i], 1)`. Values compressed to 0..n−1.
- **Count of distinct values in ranges (offline):** sort queries by r; when processing position i, `add(i, +1)` and `add(last[a[i]], -1)`; answer = sum(l, r+1).
- **2D points dominance count:** sort by x, BIT on y (sweep, §2.2).

3.2.1 Range update, point query / range update, range query

```
// range add, point query: store differences
struct BITRangeAdd {
    BIT b; BITRangeAdd(int n) : b(n + 1) {}
    void add(int l, int r, ll v) { b.add(l, v); b.add(r + 1, -v); }   // a[l..r] += v (inclusive)
    ll get(int i) { return b.pref(i + 1); }
};
// range add, range sum: two BITs
struct BITRangeRange {
    BIT b1, b2; BITRangeRange(int n) : b1(n + 1), b2(n + 1) {}
    void add(int l, int r, ll v) {                                    // inclusive
        b1.add(l, v); b1.add(r + 1, -v);
        b2.add(l, v * l); b2.add(r + 1, -v * (r + 1));
    }
    ll pref(int i) { return b1.pref(i) * i - b2.pref(i); }            // sum [0, i)
    ll sum(int l, int r) { return pref(r + 1) - pref(l); }            // inclusive
};
```

3.2.2 2D BIT

```
struct BIT2D {   // point add, rectangle-prefix sum; n*m memory
    int n, m; vector<vector<ll>> t;
    BIT2D(int n, int m) : n(n), m(m), t(n + 1, vector<ll>(m + 1)) {}
    void add(int x, int y, ll v) {
        for (int i = x + 1; i <= n; i += i & -i)
```

```
            for (int j = y + 1; j <= m; j += j & -j) t[i][j] += v;
    }
    ll pref(int x, int y) {  // sum over [0,x) x [0,y)
        ll s = 0;
        for (int i = x; i > 0; i -= i & -i)
            for (int j = y; j > 0; j -= j & -j) s += t[i][j];
        return s;
    }
};
```

If coordinates are large and points known in advance: compress, or do the offline sweep with 1D BIT instead.

3.3 Segment Tree

3.3.1 Iterative (point update, range query) — fastest to type

```
// [stress-tested] change T / ID / op; op must be associative (need not be commutative)
struct Seg {
    using T = ll;
    static constexpr T ID = LLONG_MIN;
    static T op(T a, T b) { return max(a, b); }
    int n; vector<T> t;
    Seg(int n) : n(n), t(2 * n, ID) {}
    void set(int i, T v) {
        for (t[i += n] = v; i > 1; i >>= 1) t[i >> 1] = op(t[i & ~1], t[i | 1]);
    }
    T query(int l, int r) {                // [l, r)
        T ra = ID, rb = ID;
        for (l += n, r += n; l < r; l >>= 1, r >>= 1) {
            if (l & 1) ra = op(ra, t[l++]);
            if (r & 1) rb = op(t[--r], rb);
        }
        return op(ra, rb);
    }
};
```

3.3.2 Lazy propagation: range assign + range add, query sum/min/max

```
// [stress-tested] 0-indexed, inclusive [l, r]. Delete what you don't need.
struct LazySeg {
    struct Node { ll sum = 0, mn = INF, mx = -INF; };
    static Node merge(const Node& a, const Node& b) {
        return {a.sum + b.sum, min(a.mn, b.mn), max(a.mx, b.mx)};
    }
    int n; vector<Node> t; vector<ll> add, setv; vector<char> hasSet;
    LazySeg(const vector<ll>& a) : n(sz(a)), t(4 * n), add(4 * n), setv(4 * n), hasSet(4 * n) {
        build(1, 0, n - 1, a);
    }
    void build(int x, int l, int r, const vector<ll>& a) {
        if (l == r) { t[x] = {a[l], a[l], a[l]}; return; }
        int m = (l + r) / 2;
        build(2 * x, l, m, a); build(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, a);
        t[x] = merge(t[2 * x], t[2 * x + 1]);
    }
    void applySet(int x, int l, int r, ll v) {
        t[x] = {v * (r - l + 1), v, v}; hasSet[x] = 1; setv[x] = v; add[x] = 0;
    }
    void applyAdd(int x, int l, int r, ll v) {
        t[x].sum += v * (r - l + 1); t[x].mn += v; t[x].mx += v;
        if (hasSet[x]) setv[x] += v; else add[x] += v;
    }
    void push(int x, int l, int r) {
        int m = (l + r) / 2;
        if (hasSet[x]) {
            applySet(2 * x, l, m, setv[x]); applySet(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, setv[x]); hasSet[x] = 0;
        }
        if (add[x]) {
            applyAdd(2 * x, l, m, add[x]); applyAdd(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, add[x]); add[x] = 0;
        }
    }
    // type 0 = add v, type 1 = assign v
    void update(int ql, int qr, ll v, int type) { update(1, 0, n - 1, ql, qr, v, type); }
    void update(int x, int l, int r, int ql, int qr, ll v, int type) {
        if (qr < l || r < ql) return;
        if (ql <= l && r <= qr) { type ? applySet(x, l, r, v) : applyAdd(x, l, r, v); return; }
        push(x, l, r);
```

```
        int m = (l + r) / 2;
        update(2 * x, l, m, ql, qr, v, type); update(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, ql, qr, v, type);
        t[x] = merge(t[2 * x], t[2 * x + 1]);
    }
    Node query(int ql, int qr) { return query(1, 0, n - 1, ql, qr); }
    Node query(int x, int l, int r, int ql, int qr) {
        if (qr < l || r < ql) return Node();
        if (ql <= l && r <= qr) return t[x];
        push(x, l, r);
        int m = (l + r) / 2;
        return merge(query(2 * x, l, m, ql, qr), query(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, ql, qr));
    }
    // first index i >= ql with a[i] >= v, or -1  (O(log^2 n) worst, usually ~log n)
    int firstAtLeast(int ql, ll v) { return firstAtLeast(1, 0, n - 1, ql, v); }
    int firstAtLeast(int x, int l, int r, int ql, ll v) {
        if (r < ql || t[x].mx < v) return -1;
        if (l == r) return l;
        push(x, l, r);
        int m = (l + r) / 2;
        int res = firstAtLeast(2 * x, l, m, ql, v);
        return res != -1 ? res : firstAtLeast(2 * x + 1, m + 1, r, ql, v);
    }
};
```

How to design a new lazy segment tree: decide (1) the node summary, (2) the tag, (3) how a tag changes a node summary *using only the summary and the segment length*, (4) how two tags compose (new tag applied after old). If (3) is impossible, the problem needs a different summary (e.g. store sum of squares to support range add with sum-of-squares query: $\Sigma(x+v)^2 = \Sigma x^2 + 2v\Sigma x + \text{len}\cdot v^2$).

3.3.3 Useful node designs

query	node stores	merge
max subarray sum	`sum, pref, suf, best`	`best = max(a.best, b.best, a.suf + b.pref)`, `pref = max(a.pref, a.sum + b.pref)`
count of minimum	`mn, cnt`	take smaller, add counts on tie
longest run of 1s	`len, pref1, suf1, best`	like max subarray
bracket sequence validity	`open, close` unmatched	`m = min(a.open, b.close)`; `open = a.open + b.open - m`, `close = a.close + b.close - m`
polynomial hash of range	`hash, len`	`a.hash · B^len_b + b.hash`
matrix product (DP transitions along array)	2×2 / 3×3 matrix	matrix multiply (order matters)
area of union of rectangles (sweep)	`cnt, coveredLen`	no push: `covered = cnt > 0 ? len : left + right`

3.3.4 Variations (when you need them)

- **Segment tree on values** (counts per value, compressed): k-th smallest by descending (go left if left count ≥ k).
- **Merge-sort tree**: each node stores the sorted subarray → count elements ≤ x in [l, r] in $O(\log^2 n)$. Memory n log n.
- **Dynamic / implicit segment tree**: create children on demand (`vector<array<int,2>> ch`) when coordinates are up to 10^9 and online. Offline → compress instead.
- **Persistent segment tree**: every update copies O(log n) nodes; version i = prefix i of array → k-th smallest in range via `root[r] - root[l-1]`.
- **Segment tree over time** for offline dynamic connectivity (§3.1).
- Recursion is fine for $n \le 10^6$; size arrays `4n`.

3.4 Sparse Table, Ordered Set, Treap, Mo's, Small-to-Large

3.4.1 Sparse table (static RMQ in O(1))

Works for idempotent operations (min, max, gcd, and, or). O(n log n) build.

```
struct Sparse {
    vector<vector<ll>> t;
    static ll op(ll a, ll b) { return min(a, b); }
    Sparse(const vector<ll>& a) {
        int n = sz(a), K = __lg(max(n, 1)) + 1;
```

```
        t.assign(K, a);
        rep(k, 1, K) rep(i, 0, n - (1 << k) + 1)
            t[k][i] = op(t[k - 1][i], t[k - 1][i + (1 << (k - 1))]);
    }
    ll query(int l, int r) {            // inclusive, l <= r
        int k = __lg(r - l + 1);
        return op(t[k][l], t[k][r - (1 << k) + 1]);
    }
};
```

For non-idempotent ops (sum, product) use prefix sums / disjoint sparse table / segment tree. Range GCD with sparse table is O(log) per query due to gcd cost.

3.4.2 Ordered set (PBDS)

```
#include <ext/pb_ds/assoc_container.hpp>
#include <ext/pb_ds/tree_policy.hpp>
using namespace __gnu_pbds;
template <class T>
using ordered_set = tree<T, null_type, less<T>, rb_tree_tag, tree_order_statistics_node_update>;
// os.find_by_order(k) -> iterator to k-th smallest (0-based); os.order_of_key(x) -> #elements < x
// multiset: store pair<value, unique_id>; order_of_key({x, -1}) = #elements < x
```

3.4.3 Implicit treap (sequence with split/merge, reverse, range sum)

Use for: cut a block and paste elsewhere, reverse ranges, insert/delete at position — all O(log n).

```
// [stress-tested]
mt19937 trng(91);
struct Treap {
    struct N { int l = 0, r = 0, sz = 0; unsigned pr = 0; ll val = 0, sum = 0; bool rev = false; };
    vector<N> t;
    Treap() { t.push_back(N()); }       // node 0 = null
    int make(ll v) { N x; x.sz = 1; x.pr = trng(); x.val = x.sum = v; t.push_back(x); return sz(t) - 1; }
    void pull(int x) {
        t[x].sz = 1 + t[t[x].l].sz + t[t[x].r].sz;
        t[x].sum = t[x].val + t[t[x].l].sum + t[t[x].r].sum;
    }
    void push(int x) {
        if (x && t[x].rev) {
            swap(t[x].l, t[x].r);
            if (t[x].l) t[t[x].l].rev ^= 1;
            if (t[x].r) t[t[x].r].rev ^= 1;
            t[x].rev = false;
        }
    }
    // first k elements -> a, rest -> b
    void split(int x, int k, int& a, int& b) {
        if (!x) { a = b = 0; return; }
        push(x);
        if (t[t[x].l].sz < k) { split(t[x].r, k - t[t[x].l].sz - 1, t[x].r, b); a = x; }
        else { split(t[x].l, k, a, t[x].l); b = x; }
        pull(x);
    }
    int merge(int a, int b) {
        if (!a || !b) return a ^ b;
        if (t[a].pr > t[b].pr) { push(a); t[a].r = merge(t[a].r, b); pull(a); return a; }
        push(b); t[b].l = merge(a, t[b].l); pull(b); return b;
    }
    // helpers on root (0-indexed, inclusive ranges)
    void insert(int& root, int pos, ll v) { int a, b; split(root, pos, a, b); root = merge(merge(a, make(v)), b); }
    void erase(int& root, int pos) { int a, b, c; split(root, pos, a, b); split(b, 1, b, c); root = merge(a, c); }
    void reverse(int& root, int l, int r) {
        int a, b, c; split(root, l, a, b); split(b, r - l + 1, b, c);
        t[b].rev ^= 1; root = merge(merge(a, b), c);
    }
    ll rangeSum(int& root, int l, int r) {
        int a, b, c; split(root, l, a, b); split(b, r - l + 1, b, c);
        ll s = t[b].sum; root = merge(merge(a, b), c); return s;
    }
    void collect(int x, vector<ll>& out) {   // in-order
        if (!x) return; push(x); collect(t[x].l, out); out.push_back(t[x].val); collect(t[x].r, out);
    }
};
```

Keyed treap (ordered by value) = same with split by key `t[x].val < k`. Add other lazy tags (range add) exactly like the segment tree: apply to node + mark children in `push`.

3.4.4 Mo's algorithm (offline range queries, O((n + q)√n))

Needs O(1) (or O(log)) add/remove of one element at either end. Example: number of distinct values in [l, r].

```
vector<int> mo(const vector<int>& a, const vector<pair<int,int>>& qs) {  // inclusive queries
    int n = sz(a), q = sz(qs), B = max(1, (int)(n / sqrt(max(q, 1))));
    vector<int> ord(q); iota(all(ord), 0);
    sort(all(ord), [&](int i, int j) {
        int bi = qs[i].first / B, bj = qs[j].first / B;
        if (bi != bj) return bi < bj;
        return (bi & 1) ? qs[i].second > qs[j].second : qs[i].second < qs[j].second;
    });
    vector<int> cnt(*max_element(all(a)) + 1), res(q);   // compress a first if values are big
    int cur = 0, L = 0, R = -1;
    auto add = [&](int i) { if (cnt[a[i]]++ == 0) ++cur; };
    auto rem = [&](int i) { if (--cnt[a[i]] == 0) --cur; };
    for (int id : ord) {
        auto [l, r] = qs[id];
        while (R < r) add(++R);
        while (L > l) add(--L);
        while (R > r) rem(R--);
        while (L < l) rem(L++);
        res[id] = cur;
    }
    return res;
}
```

Expand before shrinking (as above) so the window is never "negative". Mo on trees: run on the Euler tour (ET of size 2n, LCA handled separately).

3.4.5 Small-to-large merging

Merging sets of children into the parent: always insert the smaller into the larger (`if (sz(A) < sz(B)) swap(A, B);`). Each element moves O(log n) times → O(n log² n) with `set/map`, O(n log n) with hash/vectors. Classic use: for every subtree, number of distinct colours / most frequent colour / answer queries about subtree.

```
// distinct colours in every subtree; g = children lists, col = colours
void dfsMerge(int v, const vector<vector<int>>& g, const vector<int>& col,
              vector<set<int>>& S, vector<int>& ans) {
    S[v].insert(col[v]);
    for (int c : g[v]) {
        dfsMerge(c, g, col, S, ans);
        if (sz(S[c]) > sz(S[v])) swap(S[c], S[v]);     // O(1) swap of std::set
        for (int x : S[c]) S[v].insert(x);
        S[c].clear();
    }
    ans[v] = sz(S[v]);
}
```

3.4.6 Other standard-library power tools

- `multiset` as a priority queue with deletion; `prev(ms.end())` = max.
- `map<ll, ll>` as an "interval map" (Chtholly / ODT): store maximal constant segments `[l → value]`; range assign = split at l and r+1, erase between, insert one — amortised O(log n) with random assignments.
- Set of disjoint intervals (merge on insert): `map<l, r>`, find the first interval with `prev(upper_bound(l))`, absorb overlaps.
- `deque` supports O(1) push/pop both ends + random access.
- `bitset` §2.6; `__int128` for 128-bit keys.

4. Dynamic Programming

4.1 DP Design and Classic Patterns

4.1.1 Designing a DP

1. **State** = the minimum information about the past that determines the future. Write it as a sentence: "dp[i][j] = max score using the first i items with j capacity used".
2. **Transition**: what is the last decision? (last item taken or not, where the last segment starts, which colour the last node got.)
3. **Order**: compute states after everything they depend on (increasing i; increasing interval length; post-order on a tree; topological order on a DAG). If there are cycles in the dependency, it's a shortest path / system of equations, not a DP.
4. **Count states × transitions** — reduce with prefix sums/min, monotonic deque, data structures, or a smarter state.
5. Base cases, answer location, modulo, overflow, ±INF for impossible states (use `INF/2` so additions don't overflow).

Tricks: **memoized recursion** is the fastest way to a correct DP when the order is unclear. **Rolling arrays** (`dp[i & 1]`) cut memory. **Sort first** if items can be processed in any order (by deadline, by weight) — then a knapsack-like DP over the sorted order is valid. To **reconstruct** the solution, store the argmax choice per state or re-derive by checking which transition achieves the optimum.

4.1.2 Knapsack family

```cpp
// 0/1 knapsack: max value with capacity W  (iterate capacity DOWN)
ll knap01(const vector<int>& w, const vector<ll>& v, int W) {
    vector<ll> dp(W + 1, 0);
    rep(i, 0, sz(w)) for (int c = W; c >= w[i]; --c) dp[c] = max(dp[c], dp[c - w[i]] + v[i]);
    return dp[W];
}
// unbounded: iterate capacity UP.  count ways to make sum (order-independent): items outer loop
ll countWays(const vector<int>& coins, int S, ll mod) {
    vector<ll> dp(S + 1, 0); dp[0] = 1;
    for (int c : coins) rep(s, c, S + 1) dp[s] = (dp[s] + dp[s - c]) % mod;
    return dp[S];   // swap loops (sum outer, coins inner) -> counts ordered sequences
}
```

- **Bounded** (item i available k_i times): split k into 1, 2, 4, …, remainder → O(W Σ log k_i). Or monotonic deque per residue class mod w → O(nW).
- **Values small, weights huge:** dp[value] = min weight.
- **Subset sum reachability**: bitset (§2.6). Σ w = n ⇒ ≤ √(2n) distinct weights.
- Min items to reach exact sum: dp[s] = min(dp[s − c] + 1).
- **Huge sums with few coin types (Frobenius / reachability for all large X):** Dijkstra on residues modulo the smallest coin (§5.1, ACPC 2022 *Braaaains*).

4.1.3 Sequences

```cpp
// LIS length, O(n log n). For non-decreasing use upper_bound.
int lis(const vector<ll>& a) {
    vector<ll> d;                        // d[k] = min tail of an increasing subsequence of length k+1
    for (ll x : a) {
        auto it = lower_bound(all(d), x);
        if (it == d.end()) d.push_back(x); else *it = x;
    }
    return sz(d);
}
```

To reconstruct LIS: store for each i the position `pos[i]` it took in d and `prev[i]` = last index placed at `pos[i]-1`. Count of LIS: BIT over values storing (best length, count).

- **LCS** O(nm): `dp[i][j] = s[i-1]==t[j-1] ? dp[i-1][j-1]+1 : max(dp[i-1][j], dp[i][j-1])`.
- **Edit distance**: `dp[i][j] = min(dp[i-1][j]+1, dp[i][j-1]+1, dp[i-1][j-1] + (s[i-1]!=t[j-1]))`.
- **Interleaving** s = merge of s1, s2 keeping order (ACPC 2018 *Homework*): `ok[i][j]` = first i+j chars of s are an interleaving of s1[0..i), s2[0..j): `ok[i][j] = (ok[i-1][j] && s1[i-1]==s[i+j-1]) || (ok[i][j-1] && s2[j-1]==s[i+j-1])`. $25 \cdot 10^6$ booleans is fine; use `vector<char>` or bitset rows.
- **Count distinct subsequences**: `dp[i] = 2·dp[i-1] − dp[last[c]-1]` where last[c] = previous occurrence of the same char.
- Max subarray sum (Kadane): `cur = max(x, cur + x)`.

4.1.4 Interval DP

`dp[l][r]` from smaller intervals; iterate `len` from 1 to n. $O(n^3)$ with a split point, $O(n^2)$ without.

```
// number of palindromic subsequences (as index sets, non-empty) mod p — ACPC 2016 Palindromic Naming
ll countPalSubseq(const string& s, ll mod) {
    int n = sz(s);
    vector<vector<ll>> dp(n, vector<ll>(n, 0));
    for (int l = n - 1; l >= 0; --l) {
        dp[l][l] = 1;
        rep(r, l + 1, n) {
            ll in = (l + 1 <= r - 1) ? dp[l + 1][r - 1] : 0;
            dp[l][r] = (dp[l + 1][r] + dp[l][r - 1] - in + mod) % mod;  // inclusion–exclusion
            if (s[l] == s[r]) dp[l][r] = (dp[l][r] + in + 1) % mod;     // pair s[l], s[r] around any inner one or no
ne
        }
    }
    return dp[0][n - 1];
}
```

- **Split point**: `dp[l][r] = min over l ≤ k < r of dp[l][k] + dp[k+1][r] + cost(l, r)` (matrix chain, merging stones, optimal BST; Knuth optimisation §4.4 if cost is quadrangle-monotone).
- **Expressions with + and −, choose parenthesisation to maximise** (ACPC 2022 *Maximal Parentheticals*): keep **both max and min** of every sub-expression, since `a - (b)` is maximised by minimising b. With multiplication by negatives also keep both.
- **Remove/merge adjacent elements** ("zuma", "remove all with cost"): dp over [l, r] plus an extra dimension for "how many equal elements are glued to the right end".
- **Convex polygon DP** (triangulations, ACPC 2018 *Trimming Convex Polygons*): vertices 0..n−1 in order; choosing a sub-polygon = choosing a subsequence of vertices; its area is a fan of triangles from the first chosen vertex. dp over (first kept vertex fixed, last kept vertex) with transitions adding one triangle: $O(n^3)$.
- **Circular** intervals: double the array and take windows of length n, or fix the element at position 0.

4.1.5 Grid, DAG, partition DPs

- Grid paths with obstacles: `dp[i][j] = dp[i-1][j] + dp[i][j-1]`. Count paths avoiding k special cells (n, m large): sort cells, inclusion–exclusion with C(dx+dy, dx) — $O(k^2)$.
- Grid with moves S/E/SE and accumulating state (ACPC 2024 *Alpine Agility*): row-major order works because all moves go forward.
- DAG longest path / count paths: topological order (§5.2).
- **Partition into segments**: `dp[i] = min_j dp[j] + cost(j, i)`; with k segments add a dimension → D&C / CHT optimisations (§4.4) or the λ-trick.
- **State "was my neighbour already processed"**: when the order of operations on a line matters only locally (destroying buildings that damage neighbours, ACPC 2016 *City Destruction*), dp over position i with a flag for whether i−1 is destroyed before or after i.

4.1.6 Counting DPs (mod p)

- dp over (position, last value) with prefix sums over last value → $O(n \cdot V)$.
- "Number of sequences with sum S": dp over sum; with bounded parts use prefix sums to make each step $O(1)$.
- Avoid double counting: define a **canonical** construction (e.g. always extend from the leftmost undecided position, or count by "first time the event happens").
- When the DP counts objects up to symmetry, use Burnside (§7.3) instead.

4.2 Bitmask DP, Digit DP, SOS, Broken Profile

4.2.1 Bitmask DP

Assignment / ordering of n ≤ 20 items. `dp[mask]` = best for having used the set `mask`; the next item index is often `popcount(mask)`.

```
// TSP / Hamiltonian path: dp[mask][v] = min cost path visiting mask, ending at v. O(2^n n^2)
ll tsp(const vector<vector<ll>>& d) {      // returns min Hamiltonian cycle from 0
    int n = sz(d);
    vector<vector<ll>> dp(1 << n, vector<ll>(n, INF));
    dp[1][0] = 0;
    rep(mask, 1, 1 << n) rep(v, 0, n) {
        if (!(mask >> v & 1) || dp[mask][v] >= INF) continue;
        rep(u, 0, n) if (!(mask >> u & 1))
```

```
            dp[mask | 1 << u][u] = min(dp[mask | 1 << u][u], dp[mask][v] + d[v][u]);
    }
    ll best = INF;
    rep(v, 1, n) best = min(best, dp[(1 << n) - 1][v] + d[v][0]);
    return n == 1 ? 0 : best;
}
```

- **Assignment** (n workers ≤ 20 to n jobs): `dp[mask]` over assigned jobs, worker = popcount(mask). $O(2^n \cdot n)$. For n > 20 use Hungarian (§6.3).
- **Partition into groups** (min #groups each with weight ≤ W): `dp[mask] = (groups, current fill)` pairs, compare lexicographically. $O(2^n \cdot n)$.
- **Over submasks**: `dp[mask] = min over sub ⊆ mask of dp[mask ^ sub] + cost[sub]` → $O(3^n)$; n ≤ 15–16.
- Memory: `2^20 × 20` ints = 80 MB; prefer `int` and drop dimensions.
- Bitmask over a **small dimension** of a grid (rows ≤ 10): dp[column][mask of current column].

4.2.2 SOS DP (sum over subsets)

`F[mask] = Σ_{sub ⊆ mask} A[sub]` in $O(n \cdot 2^n)$:

```
void sos(vector<ll>& F, int n) {           // in place: F starts as A
    rep(i, 0, n) rep(mask, 0, 1 << n) if (mask >> i & 1) F[mask] += F[mask ^ (1 << i)];
}
// superset sums: condition !(mask >> i & 1), F[mask] += F[mask | 1 << i]
// inverse (Möbius): same loops with -=
```

Uses: count pairs with `a_i & a_j == 0` (count submasks of the complement), `a_i | a_j ⊆ x`, number of elements that are submasks of each x. AND/OR convolution = SOS transform, multiply pointwise, inverse transform.

4.2.3 Digit DP

Count integers in [0, N] with a property depending on digits. Answer for [L, R] = f(R) − f(L − 1).

```
// count x in [0, N] whose digit sum is divisible by K (K <= 100)
ll countDigitSum(ll N, int K) {
    if (N < 0) return 0;
    string s = to_string(N); int n = sz(s);
    // memo[pos][rem] for non-tight states only (tight path is unique, recomputed)
    vector<vector<ll>> memo(n, vector<ll>(K, -1));
    function<ll(int, int, bool)> go = [&](int pos, int rem, bool tight) -> ll {
        if (pos == n) return rem == 0;
        if (!tight && memo[pos][rem] != -1) return memo[pos][rem];
        int lim = tight ? s[pos] - '0' : 9;
        ll res = 0;
        rep(d, 0, lim + 1) res += go(pos + 1, (rem + d) % K, tight && d == lim);
        if (!tight) memo[pos][rem] = res;
        return res;
    };
    return go(0, 0, true);
}
```

Extra state flags as needed: `started` (to handle leading zeros, e.g. "no two adjacent equal digits"), `last digit`, `count of nonzero digits`, `rem mod m`. For "k-th number with property": compute counts per prefix choice and descend digit by digit.

4.2.4 Broken profile DP (tilings)

Count domino tilings of an n × m grid (n ≤ 10): process cells in row-major order; mask = which of the next m cells are already covered.

```
ll dominoTilings(int n, int m, ll mod) {          // m = width (small)
    vector<ll> dp(1 << m, 0); dp[0] = 1;
    rep(i, 0, n) rep(j, 0, m) {
        vector<ll> nd(1 << m, 0);
        rep(mask, 0, 1 << m) if (dp[mask]) {
            ll v = dp[mask];
            if (mask >> j & 1) { nd[mask ^ (1 << j)] = (nd[mask ^ (1 << j)] + v) % mod; continue; } // already covere
d
            nd[mask | (1 << j)] = (nd[mask | (1 << j)] + v) % mod;                  // vertical domino down
            if (j + 1 < m && !(mask >> (j + 1) & 1))                                // horizontal domino right
                nd[mask | (1 << (j + 1))] = (nd[mask | (1 << (j + 1))] + v) % mod;
        }
        dp = nd;
    }
```

```
    return dp[0];
}
```

Bit j of the mask refers to cell (i, j) when processing row i (set = covered by a vertical domino from above or a horizontal domino from the left). The same skeleton handles "place objects with local constraints" problems (e.g. minesweeper-like boards: keep the last two rows in the state when constraints reach distance 1).

4.3 Tree DP and Rerooting

Root the tree (usually at 0), compute children before parents. For n up to 10^6 use an **iterative** order: BFS/DFS order array, then process it in reverse.

```
// parent + order (pre-order). Process `for (int i = n-1; i >= 0; --i) v = order[i]` for bottom-up.
void rootTree(const vector<vector<int>>& g, int root, vector<int>& par, vector<int>& order) {
    int n = sz(g); par.assign(n, -1); order.clear(); order.reserve(n);
    vector<int> st = {root}; par[root] = root;
    while (!st.empty()) {
        int v = st.back(); st.pop_back(); order.push_back(v);
        for (int u : g[v]) if (u != par[v]) { par[u] = v; st.push_back(u); }
    }
    par[root] = -1;
}
```

4.3.1 Standard subtree DPs

- **Max independent set** (weights w): `in[v] = w_v + Σ out[c]`, `out[v] = Σ max(in[c], out[c])`.
- **Min vertex cover** = n − max independent set (trees are bipartite); **max matching** greedy from leaves: match a leaf with its parent if both free.
- **Diameter**: for each v keep the two longest downward paths `d1 ≥ d2`; diameter = max(d1 + d2). (Or BFS twice for unweighted/positive weights.)
- **Subtree sizes / sums**, **counting pairs at distance k**: small-to-large or centroid (§5.4).

Colouring with k colours minimising cost (ACPC 2022 *City Numbers* pattern)

`dp[v][c]` = min cost of subtree of v when v gets colour c = cost(c) + Σ_children min_{c' ≠ c} dp[child][c']. The inner min over c' ≠ c is O(1) with the child's **best and second best**:

```
// colours 1..k, cost of colour c = c. Returns min total cost (k >= 2 always feasible for a tree)
ll minColouring(const vector<vector<int>>& g, int k) {
    int n = sz(g); vector<int> par, order; rootTree(g, 0, par, order);
    vector<vector<ll>> dp(n, vector<ll>(k + 1, 0));
    for (int i = n - 1; i >= 0; --i) {
        int v = order[i];
        rep(c, 1, k + 1) dp[v][c] += c;
        if (par[v] < 0) continue;
        ll b1 = INF, b2 = INF; int bc = -1;          // best, second best over colours of v
        rep(c, 1, k + 1) {
            if (dp[v][c] < b1) { b2 = b1; b1 = dp[v][c]; bc = c; }
            else if (dp[v][c] < b2) b2 = dp[v][c];
        }
        rep(c, 1, k + 1) dp[par[v]][c] += (c == bc ? b2 : b1);
    }
    return *min_element(dp[0].begin() + 1, dp[0].end());
}
```

(Fact: an optimal colouring never needs more than O(log n) colours, so `k = min(k, 20)` is safe; with k = 1 and n > 1 it's impossible.)

4.3.2 Tree knapsack (merge children with size bounds) — O(n²) total

`dp[v][j]` = best value choosing j nodes in subtree of v. Merging child c into v: loop `j ≤ size(v so far)`, `t ≤ size(c)`. Bounding loops by current sizes makes the total O(n²) (each pair of nodes is "merged" once at their LCA). With a cap K on j: O(nK).

```
// sketch of merge step: cur = dp of v so far (size sv), ch = dp of child (size sc)
vector<ll> nd(sv + sc + 1, -INF);
rep(a, 0, sv + 1) if (cur[a] > -INF) rep(b, 0, sc + 1) if (ch[b] > -INF)
    nd[a + b] = max(nd[a + b], cur[a] + ch[b]);
cur = nd; sv += sc;
```

4.3.3 Rerooting (answer for every root)

Two passes: `down[v]` (subtree answer) bottom-up, then `up[v]` (answer of the part outside v's subtree) top-down; combine. Requires: the contribution of a child to its parent can be computed from the child's value, and the combination is "removable" (sum) or handled with prefix/suffix aggregates (max).

```
// sum of distances from every vertex to all others, O(n)
vector<ll> sumDistAll(const vector<vector<int>>& g) {
    int n = sz(g); vector<int> par, order; rootTree(g, 0, par, order);
    vector<ll> sub(n, 1), down(n, 0), ans(n, 0);
    for (int i = n - 1; i > 0; --i) { int v = order[i]; sub[par[v]] += sub[v]; down[par[v]] += down[v] + sub[v]; }
    ans[0] = down[0];
    rep(i, 1, n) { int v = order[i]; ans[v] = ans[par[v]] - sub[v] + (n - sub[v]); }
    return ans;
}
```

Generic rerooting with max (e.g. farthest node from every vertex): for each node compute children contributions `f(child)`, prefix-max and suffix-max over the children list, so the value "excluding child c" is `max(prefix[i-1], suffix[i+1], up-contribution of v)`.

4.3.4 Other tree techniques (pointers)

- Euler tour (tin/tout) turns subtree into a contiguous range → BIT/segment tree on subtree queries (§5.4).
- "Is u an ancestor of v": `tin[u] ≤ tin[v] && tout[v] ≤ tout[u]` (ACPC 2020 *Listen To Your Boss*).
- DP on paths/LCA: binary lifting tables store aggregates (min/max edge) along 2^k jumps.
- Tree isomorphism: canonical hashing of sorted child hashes (AHU) from the centre(s).

4.4 DP Optimisations

recurrence shape	technique	complexity
`dp[i] = min_j dp[j] + f(j) + g(i)` with j in a sliding window	monotonic deque (§2.3)	O(n)
`dp[i] = min_j (a_j · x_i + b_j)` (+ terms of i)	convex hull trick / Li Chao	O(n log n)
`dp[k][i] = min_{j<i} dp[k-1][j] + C(j, i)`, opt(i) monotone	divide & conquer	O(k n log n)
`dp[i][j] = min_{i≤k<j} dp[i][k] + dp[k+1][j] + C(i, j)`	Knuth (opt[i][j−1] ≤ opt[i][j] ≤ opt[i+1][j])	O(n²)
"exactly k groups" and answer convex in k	Aliens trick (λ-penalty, binary search)	O(n log n log C)
`dp[x]` is convex piecewise linear in a value x	slope trick (heaps of breakpoints)	O(n log n)

Monge / quadrangle inequality `C(a, c) + C(b, d) ≤ C(a, d) + C(b, c)` for a ≤ b ≤ c ≤ d implies monotone opt (both D&C and Knuth). Typical Monge costs: (sum of segment)², sum of |x − median| over a segment, number of pairs inside a segment. When unsure, stress-test opt monotonicity with a brute force.

4.4.1 Convex hull trick (any insertion/query order)

```
// [stress-tested] max of k*x + m. For min: add(-k, -m) and negate query.
struct Line {
    mutable ll k, m, p;
    bool operator<(const Line& o) const { return k < o.k; }
    bool operator<(ll x) const { return p < x; }
};
struct LineContainer : multiset<Line, less<>> {
    static const ll inf = LLONG_MAX;
    ll div(ll a, ll b) { return a / b - ((a ^ b) < 0 && a % b); }  // floor
    bool isect(iterator x, iterator y) {
        if (y == end()) return x->p = inf, 0;
        if (x->k == y->k) x->p = x->m > y->m ? inf : -inf;
        else x->p = div(y->m - x->m, x->k - y->k);
        return x->p >= y->p;
    }
    void add(ll k, ll m) {
        auto z = insert({k, m, 0}), y = z++, x = y;
        while (isect(y, z)) z = erase(z);
        if (x != begin() && isect(--x, y)) isect(x, y = erase(y));
        while ((y = x) != begin() && (--x)->p >= y->p) isect(x, erase(y));
    }
    ll query(ll x) {
        auto l = *lower_bound(x);
        return l.k * x + l.m;
    }
};
```

Watch overflow: $|k \cdot x|$ must fit in `ll`. Example: `dp[i] = min_j dp[j] + (p_i − p_j)²` = `p_i² + min_j (−2p_j·p_i + dp[j] + p_j²)` → line with slope `−2p_j`, intercept `dp[j] + p_j²`, query at `p_i`.

4.4.2 Li Chao tree (min, over a known set of query x's)

Also supports adding a line only on an x-range (descend to O(log n) nodes and insert there).

```
// [stress-tested]
struct LiChao {
    struct L { ll k, m; ll eval(ll x) const { return k * x + m; } };
    vector<ll> xs; vector<L> t; int n;
    LiChao(vector<ll> pts) : xs(pts) {
        sort(all(xs)); xs.erase(unique(all(xs)), xs.end());
        n = sz(xs); t.assign(4 * n, {0, INF});
    }
    void add(ll k, ll m) { add({k, m}, 1, 0, n - 1); }
    void add(L nw, int x, int l, int r) {
        int mid = (l + r) / 2;
        bool lef = nw.eval(xs[l]) < t[x].eval(xs[l]);
        bool md = nw.eval(xs[mid]) < t[x].eval(xs[mid]);
        if (md) swap(t[x], nw);
        if (l == r) return;
        if (lef != md) add(nw, 2 * x, l, mid); else add(nw, 2 * x + 1, mid + 1, r);
    }
    ll query(ll qx) {                    // qx must be one of pts
        int i = lower_bound(all(xs), qx) - xs.begin(), x = 1, l = 0, r = n - 1;
        ll res = INF;
        while (true) {
            res = min(res, t[x].eval(qx));
            if (l == r) return res;
            int mid = (l + r) / 2;
            if (i <= mid) { x = 2 * x; r = mid; } else { x = 2 * x + 1; l = mid + 1; }
        }
    }
};
```

The empty line `{0, INF}` evaluates to INF; don't add lines with huge slopes where `k*x` overflows.

4.4.3 Divide & conquer optimisation

```
// [stress-tested] split a[0..n) into exactly K contiguous groups minimising sum of cost(j, i) for
// group = a[j..i). cost must satisfy the quadrangle inequality.
ll partitionDC(int n, int K, const function<ll(int, int)>& cost) {
    vector<ll> prv(n + 1, INF), cur(n + 1, INF);
    prv[0] = 0;
    function<void(int, int, int, int)> solve = [&](int l, int r, int optl, int optr) {
        if (l > r) return;
        int mid = (l + r) / 2, opt = optl;
        ll best = INF;
        for (int j = optl; j <= min(mid - 1, optr); ++j)
            if (prv[j] < INF && prv[j] + cost(j, mid) < best) { best = prv[j] + cost(j, mid); opt = j; }
        cur[mid] = best;
        solve(l, mid - 1, optl, opt); solve(mid + 1, r, opt, optr);
    };
    rep(k, 0, K) { fill(all(cur), INF); solve(1, n, 0, n - 1); swap(prv, cur); }
    return prv[n];
}
```

4.4.4 Knuth optimisation (interval DP)

```
// sketch: dp[i][j] over closed intervals, C(i, j) Monge and monotone on inclusion
for (int i = 0; i < n; ++i) { dp[i][i] = base(i); opt[i][i] = i; }
for (int len = 2; len <= n; ++len)
    for (int i = 0; i + len - 1 < n; ++i) {
        int j = i + len - 1; dp[i][j] = INF;
        for (int k = opt[i][j - 1]; k <= min(j - 1, opt[i + 1][j]); ++k) {
            ll v = dp[i][k] + dp[k + 1][j] + C(i, j);
            if (v < dp[i][j]) { dp[i][j] = v; opt[i][j] = k; }
        }
    }
```

4.4.5 Aliens trick (Lagrangian relaxation)

If `f(k)` = optimal cost with exactly k groups/items is **convex** in k, then for a penalty λ solve the unconstrained problem where every group costs an extra λ: `g(λ) = min_k f(k) + λk`. Track the number of groups used (minimum count among ties). Binary

search λ (integer) so that the count is ≤ k with smallest λ; answer `f(k) = g(λ) − λ·k`. Turns O(n·k) states into O(n) per λ.

4.4.6 Slope trick

Maintain a convex piecewise-linear function by the multiset of its slope-change points. Classic: minimum Σ|a_i − b_i| to make b non-decreasing:

```
ll minCostNonDecreasing(const vector<ll>& a) {
    priority_queue<ll> pq; ll ans = 0;
    for (ll x : a) {
        pq.push(x);
        if (pq.top() > x) { ans += pq.top() - x; pq.pop(); pq.push(x); }
    }
    return ans;   // strictly increasing: apply to a_i - i
}
```

4.5 Probability, Expected Value, Games

ACPC has a probability/EV problem at difficulty 5–8 most years (Balls and Bins, Gunslingers, Concentration). They are almost always **DP over a small state space**, solved backward from terminal states.

4.5.1 Core facts

- **Linearity:** E[X + Y] = E[X] + E[Y] always (even dependent). Write the quantity as a sum of indicators: E[#fixed points of random permutation] = n·(1/n) = 1; E[#inversions] = n(n−1)/4.
- E[X] for X ≥ 0 integer: Σ_{k≥1} P(X ≥ k). E[max] via P(max ≤ k) = Π P(X_i ≤ k).
- **Geometric:** success prob p per trial ⇒ expected trials 1/p. **Coupon collector:** n·H_n = n(1 + 1/2 + … + 1/n).
- Independent events: P(A ∩ B) = P(A)P(B). Conditional: P(A | B) = P(A ∩ B)/P(B). Bayes: P(A | B) = P(B | A)P(A)/P(B).
- **Gambler's ruin** (fair): start at a, absorb at 0 or N ⇒ P(reach N) = a/N, expected steps a(N − a). Biased with ratio r = q/p: P(reach N) = $(1 - r^a)/(1 - r^N)$.
- Sum of probabilities over all outcomes must be 1 — assert it in your DP to catch bugs.
- Random permutation: element i ends before j with prob 1/2; i is the max of a random set of size k with prob 1/k.

4.5.2 Expected value DP

`E[s] = cost(s) + Σ_t P(s → t)·E[t]`, terminal states have E = 0. Compute in an order where t is done before s (e.g. "number of remaining items" decreases).

- **Self-loops** (state can stay the same with prob p): E = (c + Σ_{t ≠ s} P(t)E[t]) / (1 − p).
- **Optimal stopping / decisions** (ACPC 2021 *Balls and Bins*): `V[s] = max(value if stop now, Σ P(t)·(reward + V[t]))`. The state must capture everything that affects future probabilities — e.g. (#bins with 1 ball, #bins with 2 balls); the number of balls thrown is then determined.
- **Forward probability DP** when you need the distribution: `P[t] += P[s]·p(s → t)`; answer = Σ over final states.
- **Probability of winning with optimal play:** `W[s] = max over moves of Σ P(outcome)·W[next]` (or 1 − opponent's W when turns alternate).
- **Cycles in the state graph**:
- A *cyclic chain* (turns rotate among players until something happens): unroll. If `x_1 = a_1 + b_1 x_2, …, x_k = a_k + b_k x_1` then `x_1 = (a_1 + b_1 a_2 + b_1 b_2 a_3 + … ) / (1 − b_1 b_2 ⋯ b_k)`, then back-substitute. (Gunslingers: within a fixed set of survivors, misses rotate the turn; hits go to a smaller set, already solved.)
- General cycles: Gaussian elimination on the linear system (§7.4), O(n³) for n ≤ ~500.
- Infinite processes with decreasing probability: iterate until change < 1e-12 (value iteration) when the system is contractive.

```
// x[i] = a[i] + b[i] * x[(i+1) % k]  (cyclic chain), returns all x. Requires prod(b) != 1.
vector<double> solveCycle(const vector<double>& a, const vector<double>& b) {
    int k = sz(a); double num = 0, mul = 1;
    rep(i, 0, k) { num += mul * a[i]; mul *= b[i]; }
    vector<double> x(k);
    x[0] = num / (1 - mul);
    for (int i = k - 1; i >= 1; --i) x[i] = a[i] + b[i] * x[(i + 1) % k];
    return x;
}
```

Expected value modulo p

"Output E as P·Q⁻¹ mod 998244353": do the same DP with modular arithmetic; every division by an integer d becomes multiplication by `inv(d)` (§7.1). Probabilities like 1/n become `inv(n)`. `1/(1 - p)` becomes `inv((1 - p + MOD) % MOD)`.

Precision with doubles

Use `double` (or `long double`) and print 9+ decimals. Avoid computing tiny probabilities as products of thousands of terms (underflow → use logs). Subtracting nearly equal numbers loses precision — reformulate `(1 - (1 - p)^n` via `-expm1(n * log1p(-p))`).

4.5.3 Combinatorial games

Win/lose DP on a DAG of positions: a position is winning iff some move leads to a losing position; terminal positions are losing (normal play: player unable to move loses). Compute by memoized recursion.

Games with cycles (draws possible) — retrograde BFS: start from terminal positions; a position becomes LOSE when all its successors are WIN (count remaining successors), WIN when any successor is LOSE; positions never labelled are DRAW.

```cpp
// g = moves (position -> next positions). res: 1 = win, -1 = lose, 0 = draw (for player to move)
vector<int> retrograde(const vector<vector<int>>& g) {
    int n = sz(g); vector<vector<int>> rg(n); vector<int> deg(n), res(n, 0);
    rep(v, 0, n) { deg[v] = sz(g[v]); for (int u : g[v]) rg[u].push_back(v); }
    queue<int> q;
    rep(v, 0, n) if (deg[v] == 0) { res[v] = -1; q.push(v); }
    while (!q.empty()) {
        int u = q.front(); q.pop();
        for (int v : rg[u]) if (res[v] == 0) {
            if (res[u] == -1) { res[v] = 1; q.push(v); }
            else if (--deg[v] == 0) { res[v] = -1; q.push(v); }
        }
    }
    return res;
}
```

Sprague–Grundy: for a sum of independent impartial games, `grundy(position) = mex{grundy(next)}`; the whole game is losing iff the xor of the components' Grundy values is 0.

- **Nim:** Grundy of a heap of size x is x → first player wins iff xor $\neq 0$.
- **Subtraction game** (remove 1..k): g(x) = x mod (k+1).
- **Splitting games** (a heap splits into two): g = mex over splits of g(a) xor g(b).
- **Staircase Nim:** only odd-indexed steps matter (xor of piles on odd steps).
- **Misère Nim:** same as Nim unless all heaps ≤ 1, then first player wins iff the number of heaps of size 1 is even.
- **Grundy values often become periodic**: compute the first few hundred by brute force and look for the period.

Two-player optimisation games (both maximise own score, take from ends of an array): `dp[l][r]` = best (my score − opponent's score) for the player to move on [l, r] = max(a_l − dp[l+1][r], a_r − dp[l][r−1]).

Strategy-stealing / symmetry: first player often wins by mirroring (central symmetry on a board, pairing moves). When stuck, brute force small n and print the win/lose table — a pattern (parity, mod k, powers of 2) usually appears.